# Regina Rexx OO

Regina Rexx 3.9.7 with Object-Oriented Extensions

## Introduction, Installation and Reference

Release 1 • updated 28 October 2026
based on Regina Rexx 3.9.7 (18 March 2025)

Publication RXO-0001-0

### First Edition (October 2026)

This edition applies to Regina Rexx 3.9.7 with the object-oriented extension, Release 1, as published in the repository github.com/mikebeer/REGINA2, and to all later builds until otherwise indicated in new editions.

Regina Rexx is an open-source REXX interpreter distributed under the GNU Library General Public License. The object-oriented extension described here is distributed under the same license. It is not part of an official Regina release.

Open Object Rexx (ooRexx) is maintained by the Rexx Language Association. This extension follows the syntax of ooRexx where it can, but it is a separate implementation and is not affiliated with that project. IBM and Object REXX are names of IBM products, used here only to identify the language this work descends from.

The repository holds the source, the build tools and the regression tests from which the statements in this manual can be checked. Comments on this publication may be addressed to the project.

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# Preface

This manual introduces the object-oriented extension of Regina Rexx. It tells you how to install the interpreter from a binary package or from source, how the extension differs from classic Regina and from Open Object Rexx, and it describes the new instructions, directives and classes. It ends with sample programs, the restrictions of this release, and the error messages.

It is written for REXX programmers who know classic REXX. Some familiarity with object-oriented programming helps, but each concept is explained where it is first used.

## How this manual is organized

- **Chapter 1, Introduction**, says what the extension is and how it keeps classic programs unchanged.
- **Chapter 2, Installing Regina Rexx OO**, covers the Linux, Windows and macOS packages and building from source.
- **Chapter 3, First Steps**, shows a first program and explains when the OO features are switched on.
- **Chapter 4, Differences from Classic Regina**, lists every construct whose meaning depends on the extension.
- **Chapter 5, Differences from Open Object Rexx**, lists what is supported, what behaves differently and what is missing.
- **Chapter 6, Language Reference**, describes messages, instructions, directives, methods and operators.
- **Chapter 7, Built-in Classes**, lists the classes and their methods.
- **Chapter 8, Sample Programs**, prints the sample programs that come with the packages, with their output.
- **Chapter 9, Restrictions and Known Problems**, lists the limitations of this release.
- **Chapter 10, cREXX and NetRexx Notation**, describes the notations of these two dialects that Regina Rexx OO also accepts.
- **Appendix A** lists the new error messages, **Appendix B** the switches and environment variables, **Appendix C** the contents of the packages.

## Conventions

Program text, commands and file names are shown in `monospaced type`. Examples of programs and terminal sessions are shown in framed screens; lines you type and the lines the system prints are not marked separately. REXX keywords are shown in uppercase in the text, although REXX itself ignores case.

# Chapter 1. Introduction

Regina is a REXX interpreter for Linux, Windows, macOS and many other systems. Regina Rexx OO is Regina 3.9.7 with an optional object-oriented extension in the style of Open Object Rexx (ooRexx). With it, a REXX program can define classes and methods, create objects, send messages to them and use collections such as arrays and directories:

```
acct = .account~new(100)          /* create an object       */
acct~deposit(50)                  /* send it a message      */
say acct~balance                  /* 150                    */
exit

::class Account                   /* the class definition   */
::attribute balance get
::method init
  expose balance
  use arg balance
::method deposit
  expose balance
  use arg amount
  balance = balance + amount
```

**Figure 1.** A first object-oriented REXX program

The extension has three goals:

- **Existing programs run unchanged.** A program that does not use the new features runs exactly as it does on Regina 3.9.7: same results, same error messages, same TRACE output. The test suite of Regina itself and a set of classic tests check this for every build.
- **Object orientation is an option.** The OO features switch on when a program uses them, or when it asks for them with a marker or a startup switch. A switch can also turn the whole extension off.
- **ooRexx syntax.** Where it can, the extension uses the syntax and the error numbers of ooRexx, so knowledge and many programs carry over in both directions.

## How it works

Every new construct was a syntax error in classic Regina, or is recognized only where a program asks for the extension. That is why classic programs cannot change meaning. For example, `a~b` (no blank before the tilde) was an error and is now a message, while `a ~b` (with a blank) still means "a concatenated with NOT b".

Objects are stored in REXX variables as short internal "handle" strings that cannot be typed in a program. Assignment, stems, arguments and RETURN therefore copy references to objects without any change to the variable pool. Wherever a real string is needed, for example in SAY, in a concatenation or as an argument of a built-in function, the object's STRING method is called, so `say acct` prints what the class decides.

The object system starts only when a program sends its first message, uses a directive, or is run with `--oo`. Until then the interpreter takes exactly the code paths of Regina 3.9.7.

## What is included

| Area | Contents |
|---|---|
| Messages | `obj~name(args)` and `obj -> name(args)`, cascades `~~` and `->>`, `~name:super`, `obj~name = value`, `coll[i]` and `coll[i] = value` |
| Directives | `::class`, `::method`, `::attribute`, `::constant`, `::routine`, `::requires`, `::options`, `::extension` |
| Instructions | `USE ARG`, `EXPOSE`, `DO x OVER`, `DO WITH INDEX i ITEM x OVER`, `DO COUNTER`, `DO LABEL`, `LOOP` |

| Area | Contents |
|---|---|
| Classes | Object, Class, String, Array (with any number of dimensions), Queue, List, Directory, StringTable, Table, Set, Bag, SortedCollection, Interval, Stem, MutableBuffer, Supplier, Block, Message; `.nil`, `.true`, `.false`, `.environment`, `.local` |
| Methods | instance and class methods, attributes, constants, private and abstract methods, UNKNOWN, operator methods, mixins and multiple inheritance |
| Stems | stems passed by reference with `USE ARG s.`, stems returned with `RETURN x.` |
| Lists | LISP-style lists: the Cons class, and with `::requires 'lisp'` the functions `cons`, `car`, `cdr`, `list`, `mapcar` and more |
| Blocks | `{ :x \| x * 2 }` and `{ use arg x; ... }`: routines written where they are used, with the collection methods `do`, `select`, `reject`, `collect`, `detect`, `inject`, `count`, `anySatisfy`, `allSatisfy` and `sortWith` |
| Workspaces | In the style of APL: `[]NL`, `[]SAVE`, `[]LOAD`, `[]OUT`, `[]IN`, `[]FX` in programs, and an interactive session `rexx --ws` with `)SAVE`, `)LOAD`, `)VARS` and the other system commands |
| Memory | Garbage collection of objects that are no longer used; `--no-gc` switches it off |
| Python | Python modules from Rexx: `.Python~import('statistics')`, NumPy, pandas, json, datetime and more, through a Python interpreter built into Regina |
| MQTT | the RgMqtt package: an MQTT 3.1.1 client (`MqttConnect`, `MqttPublish`, `MqttSubscribe`, `MqttReceive` ...) and, with `::requires 'mqtt'`, the Mqtt class |
| Other notations | `obj.m(args)`, `.Class(args)`, `this`, `null`, `is`, `as`, `typeof()` in every OO program; NetRexx programs (`options netrexx`, `.nrx` files) and cREXX Level B programs (`options levelb`) with their classes, interfaces and factories (Chapter 10) |
| Control | markers `/* OOREGINA */` and `OPTIONS OOREGINA`, switches `--oo` and `--no-oo`, variable `REGINA_OO` |
| Errors | error numbers 88, 91, 97, 98 and 99 as in ooRexx, in all message languages |

**Figure 2.** What the extension adds

## How it was tested

Each build runs five test suites with `tests/run-regression.sh`. The results of this release are:

| Suite | What it checks | Result |
|---|---|---|
| trip | Regina's own test suite; output must be identical to Regina 3.9.7 | 23 of 23 identical |
| classic | classic programs, including programs that use the new words as variables; recorded with Regina 3.9.7 | 21 of 21 identical |
| oo | the extension: syntax, classes, collections, errors, loops, stems, switches | 58 of 58 |
| samples | the sample programs of Chapter 8 | 15 of 15 |
| packages | external function packages run by `regina`: an RxSock-style test package and RgMqtt against a test broker; the classic programs give the same output with Regina 3.9.7 | 7 of 7 |

**Figure 3.** Test suites

The trip and classic suites are also identical to Regina 3.9.7 when the interpreter is run with `--no-oo`. The Linux build is checked with valgrind. The Windows build runs the oo and samples suites under Wine, with `rexx.exe` and with `regina.exe`, the MQTT tests and samples with `regina.exe` and `rgmqtt.dll`, and programs with a console (`tools/test-windows.sh`). The macOS build is cross-compiled; see Chapter 9.

# Chapter 2. Installing Regina Rexx OO

## What you need

| System | Package | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Linux (Debian, Ubuntu; x86-64) | `regina-rexx-oo_3.9.7+oo1_amd64.deb` | Replaces the distribution's `regina-rexx` package. Includes the library, `rexx`, `regina`, `rxstack`, `rxqueue`, man pages, samples and this manual. |
| Windows (64-bit) | `regina-rexx-oo-3.9.7-win64.zip` | A standalone `rexx.exe` (no DLL, no installation), and `regina.exe` with `regina.dll`, which loads external function packages such as the included `rgmqtt.dll`. |
| macOS 11 or later | `regina-rexx-oo-3.9.7-macos.tar.gz` | One universal `rexx` for Apple Silicon and Intel Macs. |
| Any other system | the source | See "Building from source" below. |

**Figure 4.** Installation packages

The packages are in the `dist` folder of the repository, github.com/mikebeer/REGINA2, together with a file of SHA-256 checksums.

## Linux

Install the package with `dpkg`. If the distribution's Regina is installed, it is replaced; remove the package again to go back to it.

```
sudo dpkg -i regina-rexx-oo_3.9.7+oo1_amd64.deb
rexx -v
rexx /usr/share/doc/regina-rexx-oo/examples/01_classes.rexx
```

**Figure 5.** Installing on Debian or Ubuntu

The message files are installed in `/usr/share/regina-rexx`, the samples in `/usr/share/doc/regina-rexx-oo/examples` and this manual in `/usr/share/doc/regina-rexx-oo`. To remove the package, use `sudo dpkg -r regina-rexx-oo`.

## Windows

1. Unpack the zip file into a folder of your choice, for example `C:\Rexx`.
2. Add the folder to the PATH, or call `rexx.exe` with its full path.
3. Run a sample: `rexx demo\oo\01_classes.rexx`.

The zip holds two interpreters. `rexx.exe` is standalone. `regina.exe` uses `regina.dll` and can load external function packages (DLLs) such as `rgmqtt.dll`, the MQTT client (Chapter 7); keep `regina.exe`, `regina.dll` and the package DLLs in one folder. Both run the same programs: `regina demo\mqtt\15_public_broker.rexx` connects to the public test broker test.mosquitto.org.

The programs are not signed with a code-signing certificate. Some virus scanners therefore treat them as suspicious, especially the small `regina.exe` that loads `regina.dll`: the file is then emptied (0 bytes) or blocked right after unpacking, and Windows reports that the app cannot run or that access is denied. The files carry version information and a manifest, which makes this less likely; if it happens, add the folder as a scan exclusion in the virus scanner (with company-managed protection such as Kaspersky Endpoint Security, the administrator does this in the policy) and unpack the zip again.

`rexx.exe` contains the English error messages. For another language, set `REGINA_LANG` (for example `de`) and `REGINA_LANG_DIR` to the folder with the `*.mtb` files.

## macOS

Unpack the archive in Terminal. Files downloaded from the internet carry a quarantine mark, and the binary is not notarized by Apple, so remove the mark before the first run:

```
tar xzf regina-rexx-oo-3.9.7-macos.tar.gz
cd regina-rexx-oo-3.9.7-macos
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine .
./rexx demo/oo/01_classes.rexx
```

**Figure 6.** Unpacking and running on macOS

Without the `xattr` command, macOS reports that `rexx` "cannot be opened"; you can then also allow it once in System Settings, Privacy & Security. To install it for all users:

```
sudo mkdir -p /usr/local/bin /usr/local/share/regina-rexx
sudo cp rexx /usr/local/bin/
sudo cp *.mtb /usr/local/share/regina-rexx/
```

**Figure 7.** Installing on macOS

## Checking the installation

`rexx -v` prints the version. The version string is the same as that of Regina 3.9.7, so that classic programs which test it keep working. `rexx -h` lists the switches; the switches `--oo` and `--no-oo` show that the extension is present. The program `demo/oo_demo.rexx` checks classic and OO features and prints `ok` for each of them.

```
rexx -v
REXX-Regina_3.9.7 5.00 18 Mar 2025 (64 bit)
rexx -h | grep oo
  --oo, -O              object-oriented keywords on in every program
  --no-oo, -N           object-oriented extension off (classic Regina)
```

**Figure 8.** Checking the version and the switches

A program can test for the extension itself:

```
signal on syntax name classic
interpret 'ok = .nil~isNil'
say 'OO extension available'
exit
classic: say 'classic Regina, no OO'
```

**Figure 9.** Testing for the extension in a program

## Building from source

You need a C compiler (gcc or clang), make and git. flex 2.6.4 and bison 3.8.2 are needed only if you change the grammar; the generated files are in the repository.

```
git clone https://github.com/mikebeer/REGINA2.git
cd REGINA2
git checkout oo-syntax
./configure
make
tests/run-regression.sh ./rexx
sudo make install
```

**Figure 10.** Building and installing from source

Build with `make`, not `make -j`: the Makefile of Regina 3.9.7 has a race between parallel jobs. After changing a structure in `mt.h` or `regina_t.h`, or a node type in `defs.h`, run `make clean` first. After changing `lexsrc.l` or `yaccsrc.y`, run `tools/regenerate-parser.sh` and commit the generated files.

## Building the packages

| Script | Builds | Needs |
|---|---|---|
| `tools/build-deb.sh [dir]` | the Debian package; runs the regression tests first | `dpkg-deb`, a C compiler |
| `tools/build-windows.sh [dir]` | the standalone `rexx.exe` and the zip file | MinGW-w64 (`x86_64-w64-mingw32-gcc`) |
| `tools/build-macos.sh [dir]` | the universal macOS `rexx` and the tar.gz file | zig (`pip install ziglang`), `lipo` or `llvm-lipo` |

**Figure 11.** Package build scripts

The Windows and macOS builds leave out readline (line editing in interactive trace), the curses functions and GCI, as their scripts are standalone cross builds. On a Mac, `./configure && make` builds the full interpreter instead.

# Chapter 3. First Steps

## A program with a class

An object-oriented REXX program has two parts. First comes the main program, as in classic REXX. Then come the directives: lines starting with `::` that define classes, methods and routines. The main program ends at the first of these directives, as if it ended with EXIT.

`::requires` and `::options` are different: they can stand anywhere and never end the main program. The natural place for `::requires` is the top of the program, as for `#include` in C:

```
::requires 'shapes.cls'        /* the classes of a library */
say .circle~new(2)~area         /* the main program follows  */
exit
```

**Figure 12.** A program that starts with ::requires

```
/* greet.rexx */
g = .greeter~new('Hello')
g~greet('world')
say g~count 'greeting(s)'
exit

::class Greeter
::method init
  expose word count
  use arg word
  count = 0
::method greet
  expose word count
  use arg who
  say word',' who'!'
  count = count + 1
::method count
  expose count
  return count
```

**Figure 13.** greet.rexx

```
rexx greet.rexx
Hello, world!
1 greeting(s)
```

**Figure 14.** Running greet.rexx

`.greeter` is an environment symbol: a name with a leading dot that refers to the class. Sending it `new` creates an instance and runs its `init` method with the arguments of `new`. `EXPOSE` makes the listed variables the object's own, shared by all its methods. `USE ARG` takes the arguments without converting them to strings, so objects keep their identity.

## When the OO features are on

Message operators (`~`, `->`), `[ ]`, environment symbols and directives always work, because they were not valid in classic REXX. A few new keywords are different: `EXPOSE`, `USE ARG`, `LOOP` and the DO options `LABEL`, `COUNTER` and `WITH` used to be ordinary words. A classic program may use `loop` as a variable or `use arg` as a command. These keywords are therefore recognized only where the program asks for the extension:

| In the program or at startup | Effect |
|---|---|
| `/* OOREGINA */` | A comment holding only this word, anywhere in the file: the keywords are on in the whole file. |
| `OPTIONS OOREGINA` or `OPTIONS 'OOREGINA'` | The same; the word may also be part of a longer option string such as `OPTIONS 'OOREGINA STRICT_ANSI'`. |
| a `::` directive line | Any program with directives has the keywords on in the whole file. |
| an earlier `~`, `->` or `[` | From that point in the source on. |
| INTERPRET | Inside interpreted strings, once the program uses objects. |
| `rexx --oo` or `REGINA_OO=on` | On in every program, required file and INTERPRET string. |
| `rexx --no-oo` or `REGINA_OO=off` | The whole extension is off; programs behave exactly as on Regina 3.9.7, and markers are ignored. |

**Figure 15.** Switching the OO keywords on

Plain Regina 3.9.7 ignores both markers (an unknown option is skipped), so a marked classic program still runs there. The markers are found before the program is parsed, so they can be on any line. A marker inside a string or inside a longer comment does not count.

A switch on the command line wins over `REGINA_OO`. The environment variable is meant for programs started through the REXX API (`RexxStart`) and for `#!` scripts.

## Where objects become strings

An object is converted to a string, by sending it the STRING message, wherever REXX needs a string:

- in SAY, in concatenations (`||`, blank and abuttal) and in comparisons with a string on the left,
- as an argument of a built-in function such as `length(obj)`,
- in arithmetic, when the object is the right operand,
- as a command, in PUSH and QUEUE, in INTERPRET and in PARSE,
- as the result of the whole program.

Assignment, arguments of your own routines and methods, RETURN, USE ARG and the items of stems and collections keep the object itself. Every class inherits a STRING method from Object that returns a description such as `an Array`; a class can define its own.

# Chapter 4. Differences from Classic Regina

This chapter lists everything that can behave differently from Regina 3.9.7. With `--no-oo`, none of it applies.

## Constructs that were errors

| Construct | Regina 3.9.7 | With the extension |
|---|---|---|
| `a~b`, `a~b(1)`, `(x)~b` | Error 64, syntax error | Sends message B |
| `a->b`, `a -> b` | Error 35.1 at `>` | Sends message B |
| `a~~b`, `a ->> b` | Error 64 / 35.1 | Cascade: sends B, the result is A |
| `a[1]`, `a[i, j]` | Error 13.1, invalid character | Sends `[]` |
| `::class Foo` (any `::` clause) | Error 20.1 | Directive |
| `1 + obj`, `'41' = obj` | not possible (no objects) | Uses the string value of the object |

**Figure 16.** Constructs that were errors in classic Regina

## Constructs that keep their meaning

| Construct | Meaning in both |
|---|---|
| `a ~b` | A concatenated with NOT B (blank before the tilde) |
| `~b`, `a~=b`, `a~ =b`, `say~b` | NOT and the comparison "not equal" |
| `a [1]` | Error 13.1: `[` must follow a term directly |
| `.nil` in a program that uses no objects | The constant symbol `.NIL` |
| `use arg x`, `expose a`, `loop` | Commands or ordinary words, unless the OO keywords are on |
| `do counter`, `do label c`, `do with` | Count loops with the variables COUNTER, LABEL and WITH |
| `do x over 5` (X and OVER empty) | A loop running 5 times, as in classic REXX |
| `call f st.` in classic code | Passes the string value of `st.` |
| PARSE VERSION, `rexx -v` | Unchanged version string |

**Figure 17.** Constructs that keep their classic meaning

## Behaviour that changes in OO code

- **RETURN of a stem.** In code with the OO keywords on, `RETURN x.` returns a Stem object with a copy of the stem instead of the stem's default value. Its string value is still the default value or the stem name, so `say f()` prints the same as before.
- **Stem assignment from a Stem object.** `r. = f()` copies the returned Stem object into `r.`. In classic REXX the right side is always a string, so this cannot occur there.
- **Message instructions set RESULT.** A message used as an instruction, such as `list~append(x)`, sets the special variable RESULT to the message's result, as CALL does. Do not use a variable named RESULT for your own data in OO code.
- **TRACE.** Messages and directives are traced like other clauses; TRACE I also shows the position counter of DO OVER loops.

## Pitfalls

Three classic REXX rules surprise programmers who write object-oriented code for the first time:

- **A string followed by X or B is a hex or binary string.** `'('x', 'y')'` is an error (error 15) because `'('x` is a hex string. Write `'(' || x || ', ' || y || ')'`.

- **Tails are case sensitive.** `s.tail` with `tail = 'count'` sets the tail `count`, while `s.count` reads the tail `COUNT`.
- **A blank before `~` changes the meaning.** `obj ~msg` is "obj concatenated with NOT msg". Write `obj~msg` or `obj -> msg`.

## New error numbers

The extension adds the error numbers 88 (invalid argument), 91 (no result object), 97 (method not found), 98 (execution error) and 99 (translation error), with the numbering of ooRexx. Regina 3.9.7 did not use these numbers. Appendix A lists all messages.

# Chapter 5. Differences from Open Object Rexx

The extension follows ooRexx syntax, so many ooRexx programs that use classes, methods and the common collections run unchanged. ooRexx is a much larger system, however. This chapter lists what is supported, what behaves differently and what is missing.

## Supported as in ooRexx

- Messages with ~, cascades with ~~, `~name:super`, attribute assignment `obj~name = value`, `[]` and `[]=`.
- The directives `::class` (with SUBCLASS, MIXINCLASS and INHERIT), `::method` (CLASS, PRIVATE, ABSTRACT, ATTRIBUTE), `::attribute` (GET, SET, CLASS), `::constant`, `::routine`, `::requires`.
- Arrays with any number of dimensions: `.array~new(3, 4)`, `a[i, j]`, `dimension`, growing on assignment.
- SELF and SUPER, EXPOSE, USE ARG, the UNKNOWN method, operator methods, mixins and multiple inheritance.
- `DO x OVER`, `DO WITH INDEX i ITEM x OVER`, `DO ... FOR` with OVER, `DO COUNTER`, `DO LABEL`, LOOP.
- Set, Bag and the Message class; `condition('O')` returns the condition as a Directory.
- The error numbers 88, 91, 97, 98 and 99.

## Additions

- `->` and `->>` as alternative spellings of ~ and ~~, with blanks allowed around them.
- `::extension` adds methods to existing classes, also built-in ones, and can add mixins with INHERIT. This directive is not part of ooRexx 5: it comes from Executor, the experimental ooRexx of Jean-Louis Faucher. In ooRexx itself a method is added to an existing class with the DEFINE method of Class, and a mixin with INHERIT.
- The notations of cREXX and NetRexx: `obj.m(args)`, `.Class(args)`, `this`, `null`, `USE ARG name = default`, `is`, `as` and `typeof`, and whole NetRexx and cREXX Level B programs (Chapter 10).
- The markers `OOREGINA` and the switches `--oo` and `--no-oo` (ooRexx has no classic mode).
- LISP-style lists: the Cons class and the built-in `lisp` library.
- Python modules through the built-in Python interpreter (`.Python`, `.PyObject`); ooRexx has no Python bridge.
- Blocks `{ ... }` see and keep the variables of the code that created them (closures), and have the short form `{ :x | expression }`. In ooRexx 5 a source literal `{ ... }` is a Routine without access to those variables. The collection methods `do`, `select`, `collect`, `inject` and the others come from Smalltalk.
- Further ideas from Smalltalk: the Interval class and `1~to(10)`, SortedCollection with a sort block, `ensure` and `ifCurtailed` for cleanup code, `whileTrue`.
- Python can call Rexx blocks, for example as `key=` of `sorted`.
- `::requires` anywhere in a program, for example at the top.
- Regina's classic features remain: its built-in functions, OPTIONS, the external queue, ADDRESS WITH and the Regina API.

## Different behaviour

| Topic | ooRexx | Regina Rexx OO |
|---|---|---|
| Memory | Garbage collection frees unused objects | Garbage collection between clauses; `--no-gc` keeps all objects until the end (Chapter 9) |

| Topic | ooRexx | Regina Rexx OO |
|---|---|---|
| Keywords | Always reserved where they apply | EXPOSE, USE ARG, LOOP and the DO options need a marker, a directive or `--oo` (Chapter 3) |
| `.nil` and other environment symbols | Always objects | Constant symbols until the object system is active |
| Stem assignment `r. = stemobject` | r. refers to the same Stem object | r. receives a copy |
| `a. = b.` | a. refers to the Stem object of b. | Classic REXX: the default value of a. is set |
| Class names | `~id` returns the name | `~id` returns the name in uppercase for classes defined with `::class` |
| `::requires` position | Before the other directives; as every directive ends the main program, it stands after the main program | Anywhere: at the top as in C, in the main program or between methods; it never ends the main program |
| Sorting | `sort` uses the Comparable interface; `sortWith(comparator)` | `sort` orders the string values; `sortWith(block)` takes a block that returns 1 if the first item may come first |
| `::requires` search | Program folder, current folder, REXX_PATH, PATH | Program folder, current folder, REGINA_MACROS; extensions "", .cls, .rex, .rexx |
| Required files | Only PUBLIC classes and routines are visible to the requiring program | All classes and routines are visible |
| Error messages | ooRexx texts | Same numbers, Regina texts (English, German) |

**Figure 18.** Behaviour that differs from ooRexx

## Not available

- **Concurrency:** GUARD, REPLY, START, the GUARDED and UNGUARDED options (accepted and ignored), and the Monitor class.
- **Instructions:** RAISE, FORWARD, SIGNAL ON USER, SELECT LABEL, `::resource`.
- **Environment symbols:** `.methods`, `.routines`, `.context`, `.stdout`, `.stdin`, `.error`, `.endofline` and similar.
- **Classes:** Relation, CircularQueue, IdentityTable, Collection classes as mixins (OrderedCollection and others), Comparable, Comparator, Method, Routine, Package, Stream, File, DateTime, TimeSpan, RegularExpression, RexxContext, WeakReference, Pointer and Buffer.
- **Methods:** many methods of the String class beyond the built-in functions, for example `caselessPos` or `decodeBase64`, and many methods of the collection classes.

Most ooRexx programs that use these features need small changes. Programs that use only classes, methods and the common collections usually run as they are.

# Chapter 6. Language Reference

## Messages

| Form | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `receiver~name`<br>`receiver~name(arg1, arg2)` | Sends the message NAME to the receiver. The result is the method's return value; a message in an expression must return a result (error 91). |
| `receiver -> name(args)` | The same as ~. Blanks are allowed around `->`; the characters `-` and > must be adjacent. |
| `receiver~~name(args)`<br>`receiver ->> name(args)` | Cascade: sends the message and returns the receiver, so several messages can be chained: `list ->> append(1) ->> append(2)`. |
| `receiver~name:super(args)` | Inside a method: starts the method lookup in the superclass of the method's class. |
| `receiver~name = value`<br>`receiver~name(i) = value` | Sends `name=` with the value as first argument (and I as second): attribute assignment. |
| `receiver[i]`, `receiver[i, j]` | Sends `[]` with the indexes. The `[` must follow the receiver without a blank. |
| `receiver[i] = value` | Sends `[]=` with the value and the indexes. |
| `receiver~"+"(x)` | A message name can be a string; this is how operator methods are called directly. |

**Figure 19.** Message forms

The receiver can be any term: a variable, a literal (`'abc'~length`), an expression in parentheses or another message. Message terms bind tighter than prefix operators: `-a~size` is `-(a~size)`. A string receiver is an instance of the String class.

A message can be used as an instruction: `obj~display`. Its result, if any, is assigned to the special variable RESULT.

## Environment symbols

A symbol with a leading dot followed by a letter, such as `.array` or `.nil`, is an environment symbol. It names a class (built-in or defined with `::class`), or one of these objects:

| Symbol | Value |
|---|---|
| `.nil` | The NIL object, "no value"; `obj~isNil` tests for it. Collections return it for missing items. |
| `.true`, `.false` | The strings `1` and `0`. |
| `.environment`, `.local` | A Directory for global values shared by all parts of the program. |

**Figure 20.** Environment objects

An environment symbol that names nothing evaluates to its own name, as a constant symbol does in classic REXX.

## Instructions

### USE ARG

```
USE ARG name1, name2., ...
```

Assigns the arguments of the routine or method to the variables in order, without converting objects to strings. An omitted argument drops the variable; `arg(n, 'O')` tests for it. A name can be left out to skip an argument: `use arg , second`.

If a name ends with a dot (`s.`) and the caller passed a plain stem (`call f st.`, `f(st.)` or `obj~m(st.)`), `s.` becomes an alias of the caller's stem: the callee reads the caller's values, and everything it sets, drops or adds is

seen by the caller. If the argument is a Stem object, `s.` refers to it. Any other value becomes the default value of `s..`

### EXPOSE

```
EXPOSE name1 name2 stem. ...
```

The first instruction of a method. The listed variables are the object's own variables, shared by all methods of the same class for that object. A stem or compound variable can be exposed as well. Variables that are not exposed are local to the method call.

### DO and LOOP

All classic forms of DO work as before. The extension adds:

| Form | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `DO x OVER coll` | X takes each item of an Array, List or Queue, each index of a Directory, StringTable or Table, each tail of a stem (`DO t OVER st.`) or of a Stem object. Other objects are asked for `makeArray`. |
| `DO x OVER coll FOR n` | At most N iterations. |
| `DO WITH INDEX i ITEM x OVER coll` | Sets the index and the item: the position and element of an Array, the key and value of a Directory or Table, the tail and value of a stem. Either part may be left out, the order is free, FOR may follow. Other objects are asked for `supplier`, then `makeArray`. |
| `DO COUNTER c ...` | C is 0 at the start and grows by 1 before each pass through the body. Works with every kind of loop. |
| `DO LABEL name ...` | Names the loop for LEAVE, ITERATE and END. The control variable still works there too. A plain `DO LABEL name` group runs once and can be left with `LEAVE name`. |
| `LOOP ...` | The same as DO, except that LOOP without repetitor and condition loops until LEAVE. |

**Figure 21.** The new forms of DO

WHILE and UNTIL work with all forms. In an OVER loop, WHILE is tested after the variables have been set to the next item. The collection is copied when the loop starts, so changes to it in the body do not change the loop. LABEL and COUNTER come first, in either order: `DO LABEL outer COUNTER n i = 1 TO 10`.

### CONDITION('O')

Returns the current condition as a Directory, or `.nil` if there is none: CONDITION (`SYNTAX`, `HALT`, ...), INSTRUCTION (`SIGNAL` or `CALL`), DESCRIPTION, POSITION (the line), and for SYNTAX also CODE (`42.3`), RC and ERRORTEXT. With `--no-oo` the option O is an error as in Regina 3.9.7.

### RETURN with a stem

In code with the OO keywords on, `RETURN x.` returns a new Stem object with a copy of all tails and the default value of `x..` Assigned to a stem (`r. = f()`), it replaces `r.` with that copy; assigned to a simple variable, it is an object (see Stem in Chapter 7).

## Blocks

```
{ clauses }
{ :name1 :name2 ... | expression }
{ | expression }
```

A block is a routine without a name, written as a term in an expression. Its value is a Block object; `b~call(args)` (or `b~value(args)`) runs it with the arguments and returns what it returns. Collection methods such as `select` and the LISP functions call the blocks they are given.

The short forms are the Smalltalk notation: `{ :x :y | x + y }` means `{ use arg x, y; return x + y }`, and `{ | i < 10 }` means `{ return i < 10 }`. The expression ends at the closing brace. In the long form the clauses are separated by `;` or line ends, as in a program; a block can contain labels, loops and other blocks.

| Variables in a block | Rule |
|---|---|
| Variables of the creator | A block sees the variables of the routine or method that evaluated `{ ... }` and can change them, like an internal routine without PROCEDURE. Inside a method that includes SELF and the exposed variables. |
| Parameters | The names of a first `USE ARG` (and of `:x` in the short form) are the block's own, even when the creator has variables of that name. |
| New variables | Variables that the creator did not have when the block was called are local to the call, as are RESULT, RC and SIGL. |
| After the creator has returned | The block keeps the variables the creator had when it returned, and changes them: a block returned by a routine works as a closure (see `counter` in `11_blocks.rexx`). |
| PROCEDURE | A block that begins with `PROCEDURE [EXPOSE ...]` has only its own variables and the exposed ones, like an internal routine. |

**Figure 22.** Variables in blocks

Labels inside a block belong to the block; a CALL or function call to a name that is not a label of the block finds the labels of the code that created it, so a block can call the program's internal routines. Errors in a block are reported with the line numbers of the program. `.Block~new(source)` makes a block from a string.

```
limit = 100
big = numbers~select({ :x | x > limit })
total = numbers~inject(0, { :sum :x | sum + x })
names~sortWith({ :a :b | length(a) <= length(b) })
numbers~do({ use arg x, i; say i':' x })
```

**Figure 23.** Blocks

## Directives

Directives start with `::` at the beginning of a clause. The main program ends at the first directive, except `::requires` and `::options`, which can stand anywhere: the statements after them continue what came before, the main program or the body of the last method or routine.

| Directive | Options and meaning |
|---|---|
| `::class name` | `SUBCLASS parent` (default Object), `MIXINCLASS parent` (a class whose methods other classes inherit), `INHERIT mixin ...`. `PUBLIC`, `PRIVATE` and `METACLASS` are accepted; in this release all classes of a required file are visible (Chapter 9). |
| `::method name` | `CLASS` (a class method), `PRIVATE` (only through SELF), `ABSTRACT` (subclasses must define it; calling it is error 98.6), `ATTRIBUTE`. `GUARDED`, `UNGUARDED`, `PROTECTED` and `UNPROTECTED` are accepted and ignored. Operator methods are named in quotes: `::method "+"`. |
| `::attribute name` | Defines `name` and `name=` for an exposed variable. `GET` or `SET` defines only one of them; `CLASS` and `PRIVATE` as for methods. |
| `::constant name value` | A method that returns VALUE. |
| `::routine name` | A routine called with `CALL name` or `name()`. `PUBLIC` and `PRIVATE` are accepted; all routines of a required file are visible. |

| Directive | Options and meaning |
|---|---|
| `::requires 'file'` | Loads the classes and routines of another file and runs its main program (prolog) once. It can stand anywhere, best at the top. All required files are loaded before the program starts, in the order of the `::requires` directives, wherever they stand. The file is searched next to the program, in the current directory and in REGINA_MACROS, with the extensions "", .cls, .rex and .rexx. |
| `::options ...` | Accepted and ignored; can stand anywhere, like `::requires`. |
| `::extension class` | `INHERIT mixin ...`. The following `::method`, `::attribute` and `::constant` directives add to an existing class: a built-in one such as String or Array, one from a required file, or one of this file. A method of an existing name replaces it. In methods of String, SELF is the string. |

**Figure 24.** Directives

```
say 'regina rexx'~titleCase             /* Regina Rexx */
say .array~of(4, 8)~average             /* 6 */
exit
::extension String
::method titleCase
  return self~makearray(' ')~collect({ :w | translate(left(w, 1)) || substr(w,
2) })~makestring('line', ' ')
::extension Array
::method average
  return self~inject(0, { :s :x | s + x }) / self~items
```

**Figure 25.** Extending built-in classes

## Methods

A method body runs like a routine called with PROCEDURE: it has its own variables (except those it EXPOSEs), its own condition traps and the default NUMERIC settings. A SYNTAX error in a method that the method does not trap is passed to the caller, so `SIGNAL ON SYNTAX` in the caller catches it. Labels in a method or routine belong to that body.

| Name | Meaning inside a method |
|---|---|
| SELF | The receiver of the message. |
| SUPER | The superclass of the method's class, for `~name:super`. |
| `arg()`, `arg(n)` | The arguments, as in a routine. |
| UNKNOWN | A method named UNKNOWN receives every message the class does not define, with the arguments NAME and an Array of the arguments. |
| INIT | Runs for every new instance, with the arguments of `new`. |

**Figure 26.** Special names in methods

Method lookup searches the class, then its inherited mixins, then its superclasses. Private methods can be called only through SELF.

## Workspaces

A workspace, as in APL, is the set of variables of the current routine (or of the main program), the objects they refer to, and the routines and classes defined with `[]FX`. The workspace functions are written with `[]` in front of their name, like the quad functions of APL: `say []NL(2)`, `call []SAVE 'budget'`. They work on the variables of the routine that calls them.

| Function | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `[]NL([classes])` | The names, blank-separated and sorted: 2 variables (stems as `S.`), 3 routines, 9 classes defined by the program or the workspace. `[]NL(23)` gives both; without argument all three. |

| Function | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `[]FX(source [, more lines])` | Defines the routines and classes written in SOURCE (directives such as `::routine name` and its clauses; lines separated by `'0a'x` or given as more arguments). A name defined again replaces the old definition. Returns the names defined. |
| `[]CR(name)` | The source given to `[]FX` for a routine or class. |
| `[]EX(names)` | Erases variables, routines and classes; returns 1 or 0 for each name. |
| `[]WSID([name])` | The name of the workspace (`CLEAR WS` at first); sets it and returns the old one. |
| `[]CLEAR()` | Drops all variables, erases the `[]FX` definitions, and the name becomes `CLEAR WS`. |
| `[]SAVE([wsid])` | Writes the workspace to the file WSID.rxws (the extension is added if the name has none) and returns the file name. Without WSID the current name is used (error 98.19 if there is none). |
| `[]LOAD(wsid)` | `[]CLEAR()`, then reads WSID.rxws; the workspace takes its name. Returns the names read. |
| `[]OUT(file [, names])` | Writes all or the named variables, routines and classes to FILE (extension .rxo), for `[]IN` in another workspace. |
| `[]IN(file [, names])` | Reads all or the named objects of a file written by `[]OUT` or `[]SAVE`, without clearing the workspace first. |
| `[]GC()` | Collects unused objects now; returns how many were freed. |

**Figure 27.** Workspace functions

A workspace file is text: the `[]FX` sources, statements that make the objects, and the assignments of the variables (the objects are rebuilt without running INIT; cycles and shared objects are kept). Saved are strings, stems, Arrays (also with several dimensions), Lists, Queues, Directories, Tables, Sets, Bags, Stems, Cons lists, Intervals, SortedCollections, Messages, Blocks (their source; the variables they keep are not saved) and instances of classes with their object variables. Python objects become `.nil`. RC, RESULT, SIGL and the variables named `__WS.` are not saved.

Instances of a class can only be read where the class exists: a class defined with `[]FX` is in the file, a class of a program file or of `::requires` must be defined by the program that reads the workspace.

## The workspace session

`rexx --ws` starts an interactive session; `rexx --ws=name` (or `rexx --ws name`) loads NAME.rxws first. Each line is a Rexx clause or instruction. A line that is an expression shows its value, as in APL; an instruction or an assignment runs as usual. Lines that begin with `::` define routines and classes, up to an empty line (the prompt is then `:`). Errors are shown and the session goes on. The end of the input or `)OFF` ends the session.

| Command | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `)SAVE [wsid]`, `)LOAD wsid` | Save the workspace, load one. |
| `)OUT file [names]`, `)IN file [names]` | Write and read all or some names. |
| `)VARS`, `)FNS`, `)CLASSES` | List variables, routines, classes. |
| `)ERASE names`, `)SHOW name` | Erase names; show the source of a routine or class. |
| `)WSID [name]`, `)CLEAR`, `)GC` | Show or set the name; empty the workspace; collect unused objects. |
| `)HELP`, `)OFF` | List the commands; end the session. |

**Figure 28.** Commands of the workspace session

```
$ rexx --ws
Regina OO workspace session. )HELP lists the commands, )OFF ends it.
      prices = .array~of(12.50, 8, 30)
      prices~inject(0, { :s :x | s + x })
50.50
      ::routine vat
    :   return format(arg(1) * 1.081, , 2)
```

```
    :
VAT
      vat(50.50)
54.59
      )SAVE shop
SAVED shop.rxws
      )OFF
$ rexx --ws=shop
Regina OO workspace session. )HELP lists the commands, )OFF ends it.
LOADED shop
      )VARS
PRICES
```

**Figure 29.** A workspace session

In the session the command environment is WS, which shows the command instead of running it; `address system 'ls'` runs a command. The session keeps its own variables in the stem `__WS.`, and EXIT or RETURN in a line ends it.

## Operators

If the left operand of an operator is an object, the operator is sent to it as a message: `a + b` is `a~"+"(b)`, and the prefix `-a` is `a~"-"()`. This works for the arithmetic, comparison, logical and concatenation operators. Without an operator method, objects compare by identity (=, ==, \=, <> and the others), and the other operators use the string value. If the left operand is not an object but the right one is, the right operand is used by its string value.

# Chapter 7. Built-in Classes

All classes are subclasses of Object. Class methods are sent to the class (`.array~of(1, 2)`), instance methods to an object. Method names are not case sensitive.

## Object

The root of all classes.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `init` | Called by `new`; does nothing. |
| `string`, `defaultName`, `objectName` | A description such as `an Array`; `objectName=` sets a name. |
| `class` | The object's class. |
| `isA(c)`, `isInstanceOf(c)` | True if the object is an instance of class C or of a subclass. |
| `= == \= \== <> ><` | Identity comparisons. |
| `hashCode`, `identityHash` | A number identifying the object. |
| `isNil` | True only for `.nil`. |
| `send(name, args...)`, `sendWith(name, array)` | Sends a message whose name is in a variable. |
| `hasMethod(name)` | True if the object understands NAME. |
| `request(classid)` | The object itself if it is of that class, otherwise `.nil`. |
| `copy` | A copy of the object with copies of its variables. |

## Class

Every class is an object of class Class.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `new(args...)` | Creates an instance and runs its `init`. |
| `id`, `name` | The name of the class. |
| `superclass`, `superclasses` | The direct superclass, an Array of all direct superclasses. |
| `subclass(name)`, `mixinclass(name)` | Creates a subclass at run time. |
| `inherit(mixin)` | Adds a mixin class. |
| `isSubclassOf(c)` | True if C is a superclass or an inherited mixin. |
| `queryMixinClass` | True if the class is a mixin class. |
| `methods` | An Array with the names of the instance methods. |

## String

Every string is an object of class String. Each built-in string function is also a method, with the string as first argument: `'abc'~length`, `'a-b'~changeStr('-', '+')`, `'hello'~substr(2, 3)`. In addition:

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `upper`, `lower` | Uppercase, lowercase. |
| `equals(s)`, `caselessEquals(s)` | Comparison. |

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `startsWith(s)`, `endsWith(s)`, `contains(s)` | And their caseless forms. |
| `makeArray(separator)` | An Array of the parts; without separator, the lines. |
| `makeString`, `string` | The string itself. |

## Array, Queue and List

Sequences indexed by position. Array has holes where no item was stored and can have several dimensions (see below); Queue and List are ordered lists.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `of(items...)` (class) | A new collection with these items. |
| `[] at(i)`, `[]= put(item, i)` | Read and store; a missing item is `.nil`. |
| `append(item)`, `insert(item, i)` | Add at the end, insert after position I. |
| `size`, `items`, `isEmpty`, `empty` | Last index, number of items, test, remove all. |
| `first`, `last`, `firstItem`, `lastItem`, `next(i)`, `previous(i)` | Navigation. |
| `hasIndex(i)`, `hasItem(x)`, `index(x)` | Tests and search. |
| `remove(i)`, `removeItem(x)` | Remove by position or by value. |
| `makeArray`, `allItems`, `allIndexes`, `supplier`, `section(i, n)` | Copies and walking. |
| `toString(format, separator)` | One string; format `C` joins without line breaks. |
| Array only: `fill(x)`, `sort`, `delete(i)` | Fill, sort the string values, delete with shift. |
| Queue only: `push`, `queue`, `pull`, `peek` | Add in front or at the end, take and look at the first item. |

### Arrays with several dimensions

`.array~new(3, 4)` creates an array with 3 rows and 4 columns; an empty array also takes the number of dimensions of its first item, so `a = .array~new; a[2, 3] = x` makes a two-dimensional array. Every index of `[]`, `at`, `put`, `hasIndex` and `remove` is given separately: `m[i, j]`, `m~put(x, i, j)`. Storing beyond a bound makes that dimension larger; the items keep their indexes.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `dimension` | The number of dimensions. |
| `dimension(n)` | The size of dimension N. |
| `dimensions` | An Array with the sizes of all dimensions. |
| `size`, `items` | The number of places (the product of the sizes) and the number of items. |
| `index(x)`, `allIndexes`, `supplier` | Indexes are Arrays of numbers, for example `2,3` for row 2, column 3. |

**Figure 30.** Methods for arrays with several dimensions

`DO x OVER m` walks the items row by row; `DO WITH INDEX ix ITEM x OVER m` gives the index as an Array: `ix[1]` is the row, `ix[2]` the column. The methods that treat an array as a list (`append`, `insert`, `delete`, `first`, `last`, `next`, `previous`, `section` and `sort`) need a one-dimensional array (error 98.8). The wrong number of indexes is error 98.11.

```
m = .array~new(2, 3)
do i = 1 to 2
```

```
  do j = 1 to 3
    m[i, j] = i * 10 + j
  end
end
say m[2, 3] m~dimension m~dimensions~toString(, 'x')     /* 23 2 2x3 */
m[3, 4] = 'grown'
say m~dimensions~toString(, 'x') m[2, 3]                  /* 3x4 23  */
```

**Figure 31.** A two-dimensional array

## Directory, StringTable and Table

Collections indexed by key. Directory and StringTable use the string value of the key; Table also accepts objects as keys and compares them by identity.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `[] at(k)`, `[]= put(item, k)` | Read and store; keys are case sensitive. |
| `hasIndex(k)`, `hasItem(x)`, `index(x)`, `remove(k)` | Tests, search and removal. |
| `items`, `isEmpty`, `empty` | Counting and clearing. |
| `makeArray`, `allIndexes`, `allItems`, `supplier` | Keys, items and walking. |
| Directory, StringTable: `entry`, `setEntry`, `hasEntry`, `removeEntry` | Access by name, uppercased as in ooRexx. |
| Directory, StringTable: any other message | `d~city` reads and `d~city = x` sets the entry CITY. |

## Stem

A stem as an object. `RETURN x.` creates one in OO code; `.stem~new` or `.stem~new(default)` creates an empty one.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `[] at(t...)`, `[]= put(v, t...)` | Read and set a tail; several indexes are joined with dots. A missing tail gives the default value or `.nil`. |
| `remove(t)`, `hasIndex(t)` | Drop and test a tail. |
| `items`, `isEmpty`, `empty` | Number of tails with a value, test, drop all. |
| `allIndexes`, `makeArray`, `allItems`, `supplier` | Tails sorted as DO OVER sorts them, values, walking. |
| `string` | The default value, or the stem's name. |

## MutableBuffer

A string that can be changed in place.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `new(s)`, `append(s...)`, `insert(s, pos)`, `delete(pos, n)` | Build and change; `append` returns the buffer. |
| `length`, `string` | Length and value. |
| `substr pos lastPos left right words word countStr verify` | As the built-in functions. |

## Supplier

Walks index/item pairs, returned by `supplier`.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `available`, `index`, `item`, `next` | Test, current index and item, step. |
| `allIndexes`, `allItems` | The remaining indexes and items. |

## Cons: LISP-style lists

A LISP list is a chain of cells. Each cell (a Cons) holds two values, the CAR (the item) and the CDR (the rest of the list); the last cell of a list has `.nil` as its CDR, and `.nil` is the empty list. `say` prints a list in LISP notation: `(1 2 3)`, nested lists as `(1 (2 3))`, a cell whose CDR is no list as a dotted pair `(a . b)`, and atoms with blanks in quotes.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `new(car, cdr)` (class) | A new cell. |
| `of(items...)` (class) | A list of the items; without items `.nil`. |
| `read(string)` (class) | The list written in LISP notation in the string: `( )`, atoms, `"strings"` (`""` for a quote), `(a . b)`, `NIL`, and `;` comments. A syntax error is error 98.13. |
| `apply(f, list)` (class) | Calls the function F with the items of LIST as its arguments. |
| `car`, `cdr`, `first`, `rest` | The item and the rest of the list. |
| `second`, `third`, `[n]`, `at(n)` | An item, counted from 1. |
| `nthcdr(n)` | The list without its first N items (counted from 0, as in LISP). |
| `length`, `isList` | The number of cells; 1 if the list ends with `.nil`. A circular list is error 98.12. |
| `last`, `lastItem` | The last cell, the last item. |
| `reverse`, `copy`, `append(lists...)` | New lists; `append` shares its last argument, as in LISP. |
| `member(x)`, `assoc(key)` | The rest of the list starting at X; the first pair whose CAR is KEY. |
| `map(f)`, `filter(f)`, `reduce(f, initial)` | A list of `f(item)`; the items for which `f(item)` is 1; `f(f(initial, item1), item2)` and so on. |
| `equal(x)` | True if X has the same structure and equal atoms. |
| `setCar(x)`, `setCdr(x)` | Changes the cell. |
| `makeArray`, `string` | An Array of the items; the printed form. |

**Figure 32.** Methods of Cons

`.nil` answers the list methods as the empty list: `.nil~length` is 0, `.nil~car` and `.nil~cdr` are `.nil`, `.nil~map(f)` is `.nil`. `DO x OVER list` walks the items of a list.

A function F is given by its name. It can be an internal routine of the program (for example `square: procedure`), a `::routine`, a built-in function such as `max` or `abs`, or the name of a method that is sent to each item. An internal routine is found in the program that calls `map`, also when the call goes through the `lisp` library.

### The lisp library

`::requires 'lisp'` gives the classic LISP functions as routines. The library is built into the interpreter; a file `lisp.cls` next to the program or in REGINA_MACROS replaces it. Its source is in `lib/lisp.cls` of the repository.

| Function | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `cons(a, d)`, `list(items...)` | A new cell; a new list. |

| Function | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `car(x)`, `cdr(x)`, `caar`, `cadr`, `cdar`, `cddr`, `caddr` | Parts of a list. |
| `null(x)`, `atom(x)`, `consp(x)`, `listp(x)` | Tests: the empty list, not a cell, a cell, a list. |
| `nth(n, l)`, `nthcdr(n, l)` | Counted from 0, as in LISP. |
| `llength(l)`, `lreverse(l)`, `last(l)` | Length, reverse and last cell; LENGTH and REVERSE are Rexx built-in functions, hence the L. |
| `append(l...)`, `member(x, l)`, `assoc(k, alist)` | As the methods. |
| `mapcar(f, l)`, `filter(f, l)`, `reduce(f, l, init)`, `apply(f, l)` | Functions that take a function name. |
| `equal(a, b)`, `eq(a, b)` | Same structure; the same object or equal atoms. |
| `rplaca(c, x)`, `rplacd(c, x)` | Change a cell; call them with CALL, as any function whose result is not used. |
| `read(string)` | A list from its printed form. |

**Figure 33.** Functions of the lisp library

```
::requires 'lisp'
l = list(5, 3, 8)
say cons(1, l) car(l) cdr(l)            /* (1 5 3 8) 5 (3 8) */
say mapcar('square', l) llength(l)      /* (25 9 64) 3       */
say read('(a (b c) . d)')               /* (a (b c) . d)     */
exit
square: procedure; return arg(1) * arg(1)
```

**Figure 34.** Using the lisp library

## Block and the collection methods

| Method of Block | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `new(source)` (class) | A block made from a string, bound to the caller like `{ ... }`. |
| `call(args...)`, `value(args...)` | Runs the block; returns its result. |
| `whileTrue(body)`, `whileFalse(body)` | Calls the block, and the block or routine BODY, as long as the block returns 1 (0). |
| `ensure(cleanup)` | Runs the block, then CLEANUP (a block or routine), also when the block ends with an error or EXIT. The error then goes on, raised again where `ensure` was called, with its number and text; EXIT ends the program. Returns the block's result. |
| `ifCurtailed(cleanup)` | The same, but CLEANUP runs only when the block ends with an error or EXIT. |
| `source`, `string` | The text between the braces; the text with braces. |

**Figure 35.** Methods of Block

The collections Array, List, Queue, Directory, StringTable, Table, Stem and Cons (and `.nil` as the empty list) have these methods. F is a block or the name of a routine, a built-in function or a method, as for the LISP functions. F is called with the item and its index: the position in an Array, List, Queue or LISP list, the key of a Directory or Table, the tail of a Stem.

| Method | Result |
|---|---|
| `do(f)`, `each(f)` | Calls F for every item; no result. |
| `select(f)`, `reject(f)` | A new collection of the same class with the items for which F returns 1 (0). A Directory keeps the keys. |
| `collect(f)` | A new collection of the same class with the results of F. |
| `detect(f [, none])` | The first item for which F returns 1; else NONE (a block is called) or `.nil`. |

| Method | Result |
|---|---|
| `inject(initial, f)` | F(F(INITIAL, item1, index1), item2, index2) and so on: sums, maxima, joined strings. |
| `anySatisfy(f)`, `allSatisfy(f)`, `count(f)` | 1 if F is 1 for some (every) item; how many items F accepts. |
| `sortWith(f)` (Array, List, Queue) | Sorts in place and returns the collection. F(a, b) returns 1 if A may come before B, as in `{ :a :b \| a <= b }`. The sort is stable. |

**Figure 36.** Collection methods

A result of F that must be 0 or 1 and is not is error 34.

## Interval

A range of whole numbers: `.interval~new(from, to [, by])`, or `from~to(to [, by])` as in Smalltalk. `do i over 1~to(5)` walks it, and it has the collection methods: `1~to(10)~select({ :x | x // 2 = 0 })` returns an Array.

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `new(from, to [, by])` (class) | BY may be negative and must not be 0 (error 88.8); the values must be whole numbers (error 88.7). |
| `[i]`, `at(i)` | The I-th value, counted from 1; `.nil` beyond the end. |
| `size`, `items`, `first`, `last` | The number of values, the first and the last value. |
| `from`, `to`, `by` | The values given to `new`. |
| `hasItem(n)`, `includes(n)` | 1 if N is one of the values. |
| `reverse`, `makeArray`, `string` | The interval backwards; an Array of the values; `(1 to 10 by 2)`. |

**Figure 37.** Methods of Interval

## Set and Bag

A Set holds every item once, a Bag counts how often it holds an item. Strings are compared by value, objects by identity, as in a Table. `DO x OVER` walks the items (a Bag repeats them), and both have the collection methods; `select` and `collect` return a Set (Bag).

| Method | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `of(items...)` (class) | A new Set (Bag) of the items. |
| `add(item)`, `put(item)`, `append(item)` | Adds the item; a Bag also takes `add(item, times)`. |
| `remove(item)` | Removes it (one occurrence from a Bag); returns it, or `.nil`. |
| `hasItem(item)`, `includes(item)` | 1 if the item is there. |
| `occurrencesOf(item)` | How often the item is there (0 or 1 for a Set). |
| `items`, `isEmpty`, `empty`, `makeArray` | The number of items (with repeats in a Bag), test, remove all, an Array in the order of adding. |
| `union(c)`, `intersection(c)`, `difference(c)` | New Sets (Bags); C can be any collection. |
| `isSubsetOf(c)` | 1 if every item (as often) is also in C. |

**Figure 38.** Methods of Set and Bag

## SortedCollection

An Array that keeps its items in order: by default as `sort` orders (whole numbers by value, other strings by their characters), or by a block given to `new`: `.sortedCollection~new({ :a :b | length(a) <= length(b) })`, where the block returns 1 if A may come before B. Items with the same order stay in the order they were

added. All methods of Array that read work; `add` and `append` insert in order, and `put`, `[]=`, `insert`, `sort`, `sortWith` and `fill` are error 98.17. `select` keeps the class; `collect` returns an Array.

## Message

A message as an object, sent later or to other receivers: `m = .message~new(target, name, args...)`. `m~send` sends it and returns the result, `m~send(other)` sends it to another receiver. `target`, `messageName`, `arguments` (an Array) and `result` (the result of the last send, or `.nil`) return its parts.

## Python: .Python and .PyObject

Regina OO contains a Python 3 interpreter (the C version of the Python subset interpreter of github.com/mikebeer/python), so a Rexx program can use Python modules: the standard library (math, statistics, json, re, datetime, collections, csv, random, fractions, decimal, itertools and more), NumPy, pandas, SciPy and a matplotlib subset that writes SVG files. Python starts the first time a program uses `.Python` or `.PyObject`; programs that don't use it pay nothing.

`.Python~import(name)` returns a module. Functions, classes and attributes of Python objects are used with messages: `math~sqrt(2)` calls `math.sqrt(2)`, `coll~Counter(words)` creates a Counter, `p~x` reads an attribute and `p~x = 5` sets it. As Rexx message names are in uppercase, the name is looked up as written, then in lowercase, then without regard to case. An attribute that can be called is called with the arguments; any other attribute is returned. `::requires 'python'` is accepted and documents that a program uses Python; it is not required.

| Rexx value | Python value |
|---|---|
| a string that is a number (`42`, `-1.5`, `1E3`) | int or float; whole numbers of any size |
| any other string | str |
| `.nil` | None |
| Array, List, Queue, Cons list | list; an Array with several dimensions as nested lists |
| Directory, Table, StringTable, Stem object, a stem argument `s.` | dict with str keys |
| a PyObject | the Python object itself |
| `.Python~str(s)`, `.Python~bytes(s)` | str or bytes, also when S looks like a number |
| `.Python~kw(name, value, ...)` as last argument | keyword arguments: `name=value` |

**Figure 39.** Rexx values passed to Python

| Python value | Rexx value |
|---|---|
| None | `.nil` |
| True, False | 1, 0 |
| int, float | the number as a string (`2.5`, `1e-05`, `126765060022822940149670320537 6`) |
| str, bytes | the string |
| anything else (list, dict, module, instance, ndarray, DataFrame ...) | a PyObject; `~toRexx` and `~toStem(s.)` convert lists and dicts |

**Figure 40.** Python values returned to Rexx

| Method of .Python | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `import(name)` | The module, also a dotted name such as `'matplotlib.pyplot'`. |
| `eval(expression [, names])` | The value of a Python expression; NAMES (a Directory or Stem) gives variables. |
| `exec(statements)` | Runs statements in the main module, for example a `def`; lines are separated by `'0a'x`. |
| `str(s)`, `bytes(s)`, `kw(name, value, ...)` | See the first table. |

| Method of .Python | Meaning |
|---|---|
| any other name | A global of the main module or a built-in: `.python~len(x)`, `.python~sorted(a)`, `.python~repr(x)`, `.python~dict`, `.python~list(a)`. |

**Figure 41.** Methods of .Python

| Method of a PyObject | Meaning |
|---|---|
| any name: `obj~name(args)`, `obj~name = v` | Attribute or method of the Python object. |
| `[k]`, `at(k...)`, `[k] = v`, `put(v, k...)` | Item access `obj[k]`; several keys make a tuple (`a~at(1, 0)` is `a[1, 0]`). Indexes are those of Python: lists count from 0. |
| `makeArray` | An Array of the items, used by DO OVER: `do x over pylist`; for a dict the keys. |
| `toRexx` | Deep copy: lists, tuples and sets become Arrays, dicts and other mappings Directories. |
| `toStem(s.)` | A mapping fills `s.KEY` (keys in uppercase, as tails of symbols); other items fill `s.1` to `s.n` and `s.0`. Returns the count. |
| `string` | The `str()` of the object, used by SAY. |
| `pyType` | The name of the Python type. |
| `getAttr(n)`, `setAttr(n, v)`, `invoke(n, args...)`, `call(args...)` | An attribute by its exact name, also when its name is a method of Object (`invoke('copy')`); the object called as a function. |
| `+ - * / % // ** = == \= < > <= >= & \| && -x` | Python's operators; Rexx `%` is `//` in Python and Rexx `//` is `%`. |

**Figure 42.** Methods of PyObject

A block passed to Python is a Python function: `.python~sorted(words, .python~kw('key', { :w | length(w) }))`, `functools.reduce`, `map` and `filter` call it. An error in the block reaches the Rexx code that called Python as error 98.14 (`RuntimeError: Error 42.3: ...`); EXIT in the block ends the program.

A Python exception is error 98.14 with the Python message, for example `Error 98.14: [Python: ValueError: math domain error]`; `SIGNAL ON SYNTAX` traps it. Output of Python's `print` appears in order with the output of SAY.

```
::requires 'python'
math = .python~import('math')
stats = .python~import('statistics')
say math~sqrt(2)                              /* 1.4142135623730951 */
say stats~mean(.array~of(1, 2, 3, 4))         /* 2.5 */
np = .python~import('numpy')
a = np~array(.array~of(1, 2, 3))
say a * 2 + 1  (a * a)~sum                    /* [3 5 7] 14 */
json = .python~import('json')
d = json~loads('{"city": "Bern", "zip": 3000}')
d~toStem(addr.)
say addr.city addr.zip                        /* Bern 3000 */
.python~print('a', 'b', .python~kw('sep', '-'))  /* a-b */
```

**Figure 43.** Using Python modules

### Where Python finds modules

Modules are searched in the folder of the Rexx program (so a file `mymod.py` next to the program is imported with `.python~import('mymod')`), in the folders of the environment variable PYLIB, in a folder `pylib` next to the rexx executable, and in `share/regina-rexx/pylib` of the installation (`/usr/share/regina-rexx/pylib` for the Debian package). The packages contain the library; in the source tree it is in `python/pylib`.

## External function packages

Packages such as RxSock, Rexx/SQL, Rexx/CURL and RegUtil work as with Regina 3.9.7. They use the SAA interface of libregina (`RexxRegisterFunctionDll`, `RexxVariablePool` ...), which the extension does not change, so packages built for earlier versions of Regina need not be rebuilt. An object passed to an external function arrives as its string value, and stem variables that a package sets are ordinary variables. Garbage collection never frees data that belongs to a package.

Packages are loaded by the interpreter `regina`, which uses the shared library libregina (on Windows `regina.exe` with `regina.dll`). The standalone `rexx` executables (the static Linux build, the Windows `rexx.exe` and the macOS build) cannot load packages, as in Regina 3.9.7.

The `packages` test suite checks this: `rgnet`, a small package written the way RxSock is written (it has its own function names, NetSocket, NetConnect and so on, so that it is not mistaken for RxSock), exchanges data with a TCP server from a classic program and from an OO program that uses blocks, a Bag and garbage collection in stress mode. The classic programs give the same output with Regina 3.9.7.

## MQTT: the RgMqtt package and the Mqtt class

RgMqtt is an MQTT 3.1.1 client, built and installed with Regina as `librgmqtt.so` (`rgmqtt.dll` in the Windows zip), like RegUtil. MQTT is the publish/subscribe protocol of many IoT devices and platforms; RgMqtt works with any broker such as Mosquitto, HiveMQ or EMQX. It supports QoS 0, 1 and 2 in both directions, retained messages, wills, user name and password, and keep-alive. TLS is not supported; a local TLS tunnel such as stunnel can be used instead.

| Function | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `MqttConnect(host [, port] [, clientid] [, options.])` | A connection handle, or 0 (`MqttError()` says why). PORT defaults to 1883. The stem OPTIONS. can set KEEPALIVE (60), CLEAN (1), USER, PASSWORD, WILLTOPIC, WILLMESSAGE, WILLQOS, WILLRETAIN and TIMEOUT (10 seconds). |
| `MqttPublish(h, topic, message [, qos] [, retain])` | Publishes MESSAGE (any bytes); QoS 1 and 2 wait for the acknowledgement. 0, or -1 on error. |
| `MqttSubscribe(h, filter [, qos])` | Subscribes to a topic filter with + and #. The granted QoS, 128 if refused, -1 on error. |
| `MqttUnsubscribe(h, filter)` | 0, or -1. |
| `MqttReceive(h, stem. [, seconds])` | 1 and STEM.TOPIC, STEM.MESSAGE, STEM.QOS, STEM.RETAIN, STEM.DUP when a message came within SECONDS (default 0), 0 if none, -1 if the connection was lost. |
| `MqttPending(h)`, `MqttPing(h)` | Messages received but not yet returned; a round trip to the broker. |
| `MqttDisconnect(h)` | Disconnects; the will is not published. |
| `MqttError()`, `MqttVersion()` | The text of the last error; the version. |
| `MqttLoadFuncs()`, `MqttDropFuncs()` | Registers or removes the functions. |

**Figure 44.** Functions of RgMqtt

Messages that arrive while RgMqtt waits for an acknowledgement are queued, and MqttReceive returns them in order. Keep-alive pings are sent while RgMqtt waits. Wrong arguments, a QoS of 3 for example, are error 40.

```
call RxFuncAdd 'MqttLoadFuncs', 'rgmqtt', 'MqttLoadFuncs'
call MqttLoadFuncs
opt.willtopic = 'status/rexx'; opt.willmessage = 'offline'
h = MqttConnect('localhost', 1883, 'rexx-1', 'opt.')
if h = 0 then do; say 'no connection:' MqttError(); exit 1; end
call MqttSubscribe h, 'sensors/#', 1
call MqttPublish h, 'status/rexx', 'online', 1, 1   /* retained */
do while MqttReceive(h, 'msg.', 30)             /* until 30 s pass quietly */
  say msg.topic '=' msg.message
end
```

```
call MqttDisconnect h
```

**Figure 45.** RgMqtt in a classic program

In OO programs `::requires 'mqtt'` gives the classes Mqtt and MqttMessage (the library is built into the interpreter). `.mqtt~connect(host [, port] [, clientid] [, options])` returns an Mqtt object, or `.nil` with the reason in `.mqtt~error`; OPTIONS is a Directory with the names of the stem tails above. The methods are `publish` (1 or 0), `subscribe` (the granted QoS, -1 if refused), `unsubscribe`, `receive([seconds])` (an MqttMessage with `topic`, `message`, `qos`, `retain` and `dup`, or `.nil`), `listen(block [, seconds])`, `pending`, `ping`, `isConnected`, `error` and `disconnect`. `listen` calls the block for every message until none comes for SECONDS (forever if omitted) or the block returns 0, and returns the number of messages.

```
c = .mqtt~connect('localhost', 1883, 'rexx-2')
if c == .nil then do; say .mqtt~error; exit 1; end
c~subscribe('sensors/#', 1)
temps = .table~new
n = c~listen({ use arg m; temps[m~topic] = m~message }, 10)
say n 'readings, average' temps~inject(0, { :s :t | s + t }) / temps~items
c~disconnect
::requires 'mqtt'
```

**Figure 46.** The Mqtt class

To try RgMqtt without a broker of your own, use the public test server test.mosquitto.org of the Eclipse Mosquitto project: port 1883 without a password, or port 1884 with user `rw` and password `readwrite` (RgMqtt has no TLS, so the encrypted ports cannot be used). Everybody can read what is published there. The sample `demo/mqtt/15_public_broker.rexx` in Chapter 8 uses it.

The details are in `rgmqtt/README`. The `packages` test suite runs RgMqtt against `tests/packages/minibroker.py`, a small broker written for the tests; it was also checked against Mosquitto 2.0.

# Chapter 8. Sample Programs

The sample programs are in the folder `demo/oo` of every package and of the repository; the Debian package installs them in `/usr/share/doc/regina-rexx-oo/examples`. Each section below shows a program and its output. The output is checked by the `samples` test suite, so it is what the program prints.

| Program | Shows |
|---|---|
| `01_classes.rexx` | Classes and methods |
| `02_inheritance.rexx` | Inheritance and class libraries |
| `03_collections.rexx` | Collections |
| `04_operators.rexx` | Operator methods |
| `05_stems.rexx` | Stems as arguments and results |
| `06_data_structures.rexx` | Data structures |
| `07_dynamic.rexx` | Dynamic messages |
| `08_inventory.rexx` | A small application |
| `09_lisp.rexx` | LISP-style lists |
| `10_python.rexx` | Python libraries |
| `11_blocks.rexx` | Blocks |
| `12_extensions.rexx` | More collections and extensions |
| `13_notation.rexx` | cREXX and NetRexx notation |
| `14_netrexx.rexx` | A NetRexx program |
| `15_levelb.rexx` | A cREXX Level B program |
| `shapes.cls` | The class library used by 02_inheritance |
| `mqtt/13_mqtt.rexx` | MQTT with the function package |
| `mqtt/14_mqtt_oo.rexx` | MQTT with the Mqtt class |
| `mqtt/15_public_broker.rexx` | A public test broker |

**Figure 47.** The sample programs

## Classes and methods

A bank account class shows instance variables, read-only attributes, a private helper method, class methods that count the accounts, and a STRING method that SAY uses.

```
/* 01_classes.rexx - classes, attributes, methods, class methods
 *
 * A bank account class: instance variables (EXPOSE), read-only attributes,
 * a private helper method, a class method counting the accounts, and a
 * STRING method that SAY uses.
 */
a = .account~new('Alice', 100)
b = .account~new('Bob')
a~deposit(50)
b~deposit(20)
a~transfer(30, b)
say a                                  /* SAY calls the STRING method */
say b
say 'accounts opened:' .account~count

if \b~withdraw(500) then
  say 'refused: Bob has only' b~balance
```

```
say 'owner is read-only, balance is' a~balance
exit

::class Account
::method count class                  /* class methods have their */
  expose n                            /* own variables            */
  if symbol('N') <> 'VAR' then n = 0
  return n

::method opened class
  expose n
  if symbol('N') <> 'VAR' then n = 0
  n = n + 1

::attribute owner get                 /* getters only */
::attribute balance get

::method init                         /* runs for every ~new */
  expose owner balance
  use arg owner, balance
  if arg(2, 'O') then balance = 0
  self~class~opened

::method deposit
  expose balance
  use arg amount
  if self~valid(amount) then balance = balance + amount

::method withdraw                     /* returns .true or .false */
  expose balance
  use arg amount
  if \self~valid(amount) | amount > balance then return .false
  balance = balance - amount
  return .true

::method transfer
  use arg amount, other
  if self~withdraw(amount) then other~deposit(amount)

::method valid private                /* only callable via self */
  use arg amount
  return datatype(amount, 'N') & amount > 0

::method string
  expose owner balance
  return left(owner, 8) right(format(balance, , 2), 10)
```

**Figure 48.** 01_classes.rexx

```
rexx 01_classes.rexx
Alice        120.00
Bob           50.00
accounts opened: 2
refused: Bob has only 50
owner is read-only, balance is 120
```

**Figure 49.** Output of 01_classes.rexx

## Inheritance and class libraries

Shapes with an abstract AREA method, defined in the library `shapes.cls` and loaded with `::requires`. The loop handles every shape the same way (polymorphism).

```
/* 02_inheritance.rexx - inheritance, polymorphism, ::requires
 *
 * The classes live in shapes.cls. Every shape answers AREA in its own
 * way; the loop doesn't care which kind of shape it has.
 */
::requires 'shapes.cls'                /* load the class library */

shapes = .array~of(.circle~new(1), .rectangle~new(2, 3), .square~new(4))
total = 0
do s over shapes
  say s~describe
  total = total + s~area
end
say 'total area' format(total, , 2)

sq = shapes[3]
say 'a square is a rectangle:' sq~isA(.rectangle)
say 'and a shape:' sq~isA(.shape) ' class:' sq~class~id
say 'superclass of Square:' .square~superclass~id

signal on syntax name abstract
x = .shape~new('blob')~area            /* Shape doesn't implement AREA */
exit
abstract:
  say 'as expected:' condition('D')
```

**Figure 50.** 02_inheritance.rexx

```
/* shapes.cls - a small class library, loaded with ::requires 'shapes.cls'
 * Shape is abstract: every subclass must implement AREA.
 */
::class Shape public
::attribute name get
::method init
  expose name
  use arg name
::method area abstract
::method describe
  return left(self~name, 10) 'area' format(self~area, , 2)

::class Circle subclass Shape public
::constant pi 3.14159265
::method init
  expose r
  use arg r
  self~init:super('circle')          /* run Shape's INIT too */
::method area
  expose r
  return self~pi * r * r

::class Rectangle subclass Shape public
::method init
  expose w h
  use arg w, h, name
  if arg(3, 'O') then name = 'rectangle'
  self~init:super(name)
::method area
  expose w h
  return w * h

::class Square subclass Rectangle public
::method init
```

```
  use arg side
  self~init:super(side, side, 'square')
```

**Figure 51.** shapes.cls

```
rexx 02_inheritance.rexx
circle     area 3.14
rectangle  area 6.00
square     area 16.00
total area 25.14
a square is a rectangle: 1
and a shape: 1  class: SQUARE
superclass of Square: RECTANGLE
as expected: Error 98.6: [Method "AREA" is abstract]
```

**Figure 52.** Output of 02_inheritance.rexx

## Collections

Counting words with a Directory, sorting with an Array, a queue of jobs, objects as keys in a Table, and a Supplier.

```
/* 03_collections.rexx - Array, Directory, Queue, Table, Supplier
 *
 * Counts the words of a text with a Directory, sorts them with an Array,
 * walks a queue of jobs, keeps objects as keys in a Table and fills a
 * two-dimensional array.
 */
text = 'the quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog the fox sleeps'

/* word frequencies: Directory index -> count */
counts = .directory~new
do w over text~makeArray(' ')          /* a string split into an Array */
  if counts~hasIndex(w) then counts[w] = counts[w] + 1
  else counts[w] = 1
end
say counts~items 'different words'

/* sort "count word" pairs; right() makes the counts sort as text */
pairs = .array~new
do with index w item n over counts
  pairs~append(right(n, 3) w)
end
pairs~sort
say 'most frequent:'
do i = pairs~items to pairs~items - 2 by -1
  parse value pairs[i] with n w
  say '  ' left(w, 6) n
end

/* a queue of jobs: first in, first out */
jobs = .queue~new
jobs~queue('print report')
jobs~queue('send mail')
jobs~push('urgent: backup')            /* PUSH puts it in front */
do while \jobs~isEmpty
  say 'doing' jobs~pull
end

/* a Table accepts objects as indexes */
alice = .directory~new; alice['name'] = 'Alice'
```

```
bob = .directory~new;   bob['name'] = 'Bob'
manager = .table~new
manager[bob] = alice
say bob['name'] 'reports to' manager[bob]['name']

/* a Supplier walks index/item pairs */
s = .array~of('red', 'green', 'blue')~supplier
do while s~available
  say s~index':' s~item
  s~next
end

/* an array with two dimensions: a small multiplication table */
t = .array~new(3, 3)
do i = 1 to 3
  do j = 1 to 3
    t[i, j] = i * j
  end
end
say 'table' t~dimensions~toString(, 'x')':'
do i = 1 to t~dimension(1)
  say '  ' right(t[i, 1], 2) right(t[i, 2], 2) right(t[i, 3], 2)
end
```

**Figure 53.** 03_collections.rexx

```
rexx 03_collections.rexx
9 different words
most frequent:
   the    3
   fox    2
   sleeps 1
doing urgent: backup
doing print report
doing send mail
Bob reports to Alice
1: red
2: green
3: blue
table 3x3:
    1  2  3
    2  4  6
    3  6  9
```

**Figure 54.** Output of 03_collections.rexx

## Operator methods

A Fraction class that defines `+ - * / = <` and the prefix minus, so fractions calculate exactly like numbers.

```
/* 04_operators.rexx - operator methods
 *
 * A Fraction class that defines + - * / = < and the prefix minus.
 * When the left operand of an operator is an object, Rexx sends the
 * operator as a message to it, so a + b means a~"+"(b).
 */
a = .fraction~new(1, 2)
b = .fraction~new(1, 3)
say a '+' b '=' a + b
say a '-' b '=' a - b
say a '*' b '=' a * b
```

```
say a '/' b '=' a / b
say '-('a') =' (-a)                  /* prefix minus: a~"-"() */
say a '+ 1 =' a + 1                    /* plain numbers work too */
say 'a = 2/4 ?' (a = .fraction~new(2, 4))
say 'b < a ?' (b < a)

/* sum of 1/1 + 1/2 + ... + 1/6, exactly */
sum = .fraction~new(0)
do n = 1 to 6
  sum = sum + .fraction~new(1, n)
end
say 'harmonic(6) =' sum '=' format(sum~value, , 5)
exit

::class Fraction
::method init                          /* stored in lowest terms */
  expose num den
  use arg num, den
  if arg(2, 'O') then den = 1
  if den < 0 then do; num = -num; den = -den; end
  g = gcd(abs(num), den)
  num = num % g; den = den % g
::method num;   expose num; return num
::method den;   expose den; return den
::method value; expose num den; return num / den

::method "+"
  expose num den
  use arg o
  o = asFraction(o)
  return .fraction~new(num * o~den + o~num * den, den * o~den)
::method "-"
  expose num den
  if arg() = 0 then return .fraction~new(-num, den)    /* prefix minus */
  use arg o
  o = asFraction(o)
  return .fraction~new(num * o~den - o~num * den, den * o~den)
::method "*"
  expose num den
  use arg o
  o = asFraction(o)
  return .fraction~new(num * o~num, den * o~den)
::method "/"
  expose num den
  use arg o
  o = asFraction(o)
  return .fraction~new(num * o~den, den * o~num)
::method "="
  expose num den
  use arg o
  o = asFraction(o)
  return num = o~num & den = o~den
::method "<"
  expose num den
  use arg o
  o = asFraction(o)
  return num * o~den < o~num * den
::method string
  expose num den
  if den = 1 then return num
  return num'/'den
```

```
::routine asFraction                  /* accept 3 as well as 3/1 */
  use arg x
  if x~isA(.fraction) then return x
  return .fraction~new(x)

::routine gcd
  use arg a, b
  do while b > 0
    parse value b a // b with a b
  end
  if a = 0 then return 1
  return a
```

**Figure 55.** 04_operators.rexx

```
rexx 04_operators.rexx
1/2 + 1/3 = 5/6
1/2 - 1/3 = 1/6
1/2 * 1/3 = 1/6
1/2 / 1/3 = 3/2
-(1/2) = -1/2
1/2 + 1 = 3/2
a = 2/4 ? 1
b < a ? 1
harmonic(6) = 49/20 = 2.45000
```

**Figure 56.** Output of 04_operators.rexx

## Stems as arguments and results

A routine that sorts the caller's stem in place, a routine that returns a new stem, and a returned stem used as an object.

```
/* 05_stems.rexx - stems by reference, stems as results, Stem objects
 *
 * Classic Rexx passes a stem as the string "NAME.", so routines usually
 * EXPOSE global stems. With the OO extension, USE ARG s. binds the
 * caller's stem directly, and RETURN x. gives a whole stem back.
 * The marker below switches the OO keywords on for this file.
 */
/* OOREGINA */
names.0 = 4
names.1 = 'Wilma'; names.2 = 'Fred'; names.3 = 'Barney'; names.4 = 'Betty'

call sortstem names.                  /* sorted in place */
do i = 1 to names.0
  say i names.i
end

long. = filter(names., 5)             /* a new stem comes back */
say long.0 'names longer than 5:' long.1

call addtotals names., 'COUNT'     /* tails are case sensitive */
say 'added by the routine:' names.count

/* a returned stem kept in a variable is a Stem object */
s = filter(names., 0)
say 'items' s~items '- first' s[1] '- tails' s~allIndexes~toString(, ' ')
do with index t item v over s
  say '  'left(t, 6) v
end
```

```
exit

sortstem: procedure                    /* a simple insertion sort */
  use arg s.                           /* s. is the caller's stem */
  do i = 2 to s.0
    v = s.i
    do j = i - 1 to 1 by -1 while s.j > v
      k = j + 1; s.k = s.j
    end
    k = j + 1; s.k = v
  end
  return

filter: procedure                      /* names longer than min */
  use arg in., min
  out.0 = 0
  do i = 1 to in.0
    if length(in.i) > min then do
      n = out.0 + 1; out.n = in.i; out.0 = n
    end
  end
  return out.

addtotals: procedure
  use arg s., tail
  s.tail = s.0
  return
```

**Figure 57.** 05_stems.rexx

```
rexx 05_stems.rexx
1 Barney
2 Betty
3 Fred
4 Wilma
1 names longer than 5: Barney
added by the routine: 4
items 5 - first Barney - tails 0 1 2 3 4
  0      4
  1      Barney
  2      Betty
  3      Fred
  4      Wilma
```

**Figure 58.** Output of 05_stems.rexx

## Data structures

A Stack built on Array and a binary search tree of Node objects linked by references.

```
/* 06_data_structures.rexx - building your own data structures
 *
 * A Stack as a subclass of Array, and a binary search tree made of Node
 * objects that refer to each other. .nil marks a missing child.
 */
st = .stack~new
st~push('a'); st~push('b'); st~push('c')
say 'stack top' st~peek', size' st~items
say 'popped' st~pop st~pop', left' st~items

tree = .tree~new
```

```
do w over 'mango apple peach banana cherry apple kiwi'~makeArray(' ')
  tree~insert(w)
end
say 'tree holds' tree~count 'distinct words'
say 'in order :' tree~inorder~toString(, ' ')
say 'has kiwi :' tree~contains('kiwi')
say 'has lemon:' tree~contains('lemon')
say 'depth    :' tree~depth
exit

::class Stack subclass Array           /* inherits APPEND, ITEMS, ... */
::method push
  use arg item
  self~append(item)
::method pop
  if self~items = 0 then return .nil
  return self~remove(self~last)
::method peek
  if self~items = 0 then return .nil
  return self[self~last]

::class Node
::attribute value
::attribute left
::attribute right
::method init
  expose value left right
  use arg value
  left = .nil; right = .nil

::class Tree
::method init
  expose root count
  root = .nil; count = 0
::attribute count get

::method insert
  expose root count
  use arg v
  if root~isNil then do
    root = .node~new(v); count = 1; return
  end
  n = root
  do forever
    select
      when v == n~value then return            /* already there */
      when v << n~value then do
        if n~left~isNil then do; n~left = .node~new(v); leave; end
        n = n~left
      end
      otherwise
        if n~right~isNil then do; n~right = .node~new(v); leave; end
        n = n~right
    end
  end
  count = count + 1

::method contains
  expose root
  use arg v
  n = root
  do while \n~isNil
```

```
    if v == n~value then return .true
    if v << n~value then n = n~left
    else n = n~right
  end
  return .false

::method inorder                      /* sorted items, recursively */
  expose root
  list = .array~new
  call walk root, list
  return list

::method depth
  expose root
  return height(root)

::routine walk
  use arg n, list
  if n~isNil then return
  call walk n~left, list
  list~append(n~value)
  call walk n~right, list

::routine height
  use arg n
  if n~isNil then return 0
  return 1 + max(height(n~left), height(n~right))
```

**Figure 59.** 06_data_structures.rexx

```
rexx 06_data_structures.rexx
stack top c, size 3
popped c b, left 1
tree holds 6 distinct words
in order : apple banana cherry kiwi mango peach
has kiwi : 1
has lemon: 0
depth    : 5
```

**Figure 60.** Output of 06_data_structures.rexx

## Dynamic messages

A logging proxy built with UNKNOWN, a mixin class that adds PRINT to two unrelated classes, and messages chosen at run time with SEND and SENDWITH.

```
/* 07_dynamic.rexx - UNKNOWN, mixins, messages chosen at run time
 *
 * A logging proxy forwards every message it doesn't know to another
 * object (UNKNOWN). A mixin adds the same methods to unrelated classes
 * (INHERIT). SEND and SENDWITH send a message whose name is in a variable.
 */
list = .array~new
log = .logger~new(list)               /* the proxy wraps the Array */
log~append('first')
log~append('second')
say 'proxied array has' log~items 'items:' log~toString(, ', ')

/* a mixin: Printable adds PRINT to two unrelated classes */
.point~new(3, 4)~print
.person~new('Ada', 36)~print
```

```
say 'Person has PRINT:' .person~new('x', 0)~hasMethod('print')
say 'Printable is a mixin:' .printable~queryMixinClass
say 'Person inherits it:' .person~isSubclassOf(.printable)

/* message names chosen at run time */
p = .point~new(6, 8)
do m over .array~of('x', 'y', 'length')
  say 'p~'m '=' p~send(m)
end
say 'scaled:' p~sendWith('scale', .array~of(10))
exit

::class Logger
::method init
  expose target
  use arg target
::method unknown                        /* any message not defined here */
  expose target
  use arg name, args
  say '  [log]' name 'with' args~items 'argument(s)'
  return target~sendWith(name, args)

::class Printable mixinclass Object
::method print
  say self~class~id':' self~describe

::class Point inherit Printable
::method init
  expose x y
  use arg x, y
::method x;      expose x; return x
::method y;      expose y; return y
::method length; expose x y; return sqrt(x * x + y * y)
::method scale
  expose x y
  use arg k
  return .point~new(x * k, y * k)
::method describe
  expose x y
  return '(' || x || ', ' || y || ')'   /* not '('x: that is a hex string */
::method string
  return self~describe

::class Person inherit Printable
::method init
  expose name age
  use arg name, age
::method describe
  expose name age
  return name 'aged' age

::routine sqrt                          /* Newton's method */
  use arg n
  if n = 0 then return 0
  r = n
  do 20
    r = (r + n / r) / 2
  end
  return format(r, , 4) / 1             /* / 1 drops trailing zeros */
```

**Figure 61.** 07_dynamic.rexx

```
rexx 07_dynamic.rexx
  [log] APPEND with 1 argument(s)
  [log] APPEND with 1 argument(s)
  [log] ITEMS with 0 argument(s)
  [log] TOSTRING with 1 argument(s)
proxied array has 2 items: first, second
POINT: (3, 4)
PERSON: Ada aged 36
Person has PRINT: 1
Printable is a mixin: 1
Person inherits it: 1
p~x = 6
p~y = 8
p~length = 10
scaled: (60, 80)
```

**Figure 62.** Output of 07_dynamic.rexx

## A small application

Stock keeping with Product and Inventory classes: orders, a sorted value report and a reorder list.

```
/* 08_inventory.rexx - a small application: stock keeping
 *
 * Products are objects, the inventory is a class holding a Directory of
 * products by article number. Orders change the stock; a report lists
 * the stock value, sorted, and the articles to reorder.
 */
data = 'A100 Screwdriver 4.50 120 50;',
       'A200 Hammer      12.90  15 20;',
       'B310 Drill       89.00   4  5;',
       'B320 Saw         24.00  30 10;',
       'C900 Toolbox     35.50   8  5'

inv = .inventory~new
do line over data~makeArray(';')
  parse var line id name price qty minimum .
  inv~add(.product~new(id, name, price, qty, minimum))
end

orders = .array~of('A200 10', 'B310 3', 'C900 9', 'X999 1', 'A100 25')
do o over orders
  parse var o id n
  say left(o, 10) '->' inv~order(id, n)
end
say
call report inv
exit

report: procedure
  use arg inv
  say 'Article Name          Qty    Value'
  do p over inv~byValue
    say left(p~id, 7) left(p~name, 12) right(p~qty, 5) right(format(p~value, , 2), 8)
  end
  say copies('-', 35)
  say left('Total', 25) right(format(inv~totalValue, , 2), 10)
  reorder = inv~below
  if reorder~items > 0 then
    say 'Reorder:' reorder~toString(, ', ')
  return
```

```
::class Product
::attribute id get
::attribute name get
::attribute price get
::attribute qty get
::attribute minimum get
::method init
  expose id name price qty minimum
  use arg id, name, price, qty, minimum
::method take                          /* returns .false if not enough */
  expose qty
  use arg n
  if n > qty then return .false
  qty = qty - n
  return .true
::method value
  expose qty price
  return qty * price
::method low
  expose qty minimum
  return qty < minimum

::class Inventory
::method init
  expose items
  items = .directory~new
::method add
  expose items
  use arg p
  items[p~id] = p
::method order
  expose items
  use arg id, n
  if \items~hasIndex(id) then return 'unknown article'
  p = items[id]
  if \p~take(n) then return 'only' p~qty 'in stock'
  return 'ok, left' p~qty
::method totalValue
  expose items
  t = 0
  do p over items~allItems
    t = t + p~value
  end
  return t
::method below                         /* names of articles to reorder */
  expose items
  list = .array~new
  do with index id item p over items
    if p~low then list~append(p~name)
  end
  return list
::method byValue                       /* products, highest value first */
  expose items
  keys = .array~new
  do with index id item p over items
    keys~append(right(format(p~value, , 2), 12) id)
  end
  keys~sort
  sorted = .array~new                  /* not "result": a message   */
  do i = keys~items to 1 by -1         /* instruction sets RESULT   */
    sorted~append(items[word(keys[i], 2)])
  end
```

```
  return sorted
```

**Figure 63.** 08_inventory.rexx

```
rexx 08_inventory.rexx
A200 10    -> ok, left 5
B310 3     -> ok, left 1
C900 9     -> only 8 in stock
X999 1     -> unknown article
A100 25    -> ok, left 95

Article Name          Qty    Value
B320    Saw             30   720.00
A100    Screwdriver     95   427.50
C900    Toolbox          8   284.00
B310    Drill            1    89.00
A200    Hammer           5    64.50
-----------------------------------
Total                        1585.00
Reorder: Hammer, Drill
```

**Figure 64.** Output of 08_inventory.rexx

## LISP-style lists

An evaluator for expressions in LISP notation such as `(* 2 (+ 3 4))`, quicksort and flatten written recursively, and an association list.

```
/* 09_lisp.rexx - LISP-style list processing
 *
 * ::requires 'lisp' gives the LISP functions: cons, car, cdr, list,
 * null, atom, append, mapcar, ... Lists are made of Cons cells and .nil
 * is the empty list. The program reads expressions written in LISP
 * notation, evaluates them, and shows recursive list functions.
 */
::requires 'lisp'

/* expressions in prefix notation, read from strings */
do e over .array~of('(+ 1 2 3)', '(* 2 (+ 3 4))', '(- 10 (/ 9 3) 1)', '(max 4 (* 2 5) 7)')
  x = read(e)
  say left(x, 22) '=' evaluate(x)
end

/* recursive list functions in the style of LISP */
l = list(5, 3, 8, 1, 9, 2)
say 'list     ' l
say 'sorted   ' qsort(l)
say 'sum      ' sum(l)
say 'squares  ' mapcar('square', l)
say 'evens    ' filter('even', l)
say 'flattened' flatten(read('(1 (2 (3 4)) ((5) 6))'))

/* an association list: a small phone book */
book = list(cons('alice', 4711), cons('bob', 1234), cons('carol', 5555))
say 'bob has  ' cdr(assoc('bob', book))
exit

evaluate: procedure            /* (op arg1 arg2 ...) or a number */
  use arg x
  if atom(x) then return x
  op = car(x)
```

```
  args = mapcar('evaluate', cdr(x))
  select
    when op = '+' then return reduce('plus', args, 0)
    when op = '*' then return reduce('times', args, 1)
    when op = '-' then return reduce('minus', args)
    when op = '/' then return reduce('divide', args)
    otherwise return apply(op, args)       /* any Rexx function: max, min, ... */
  end

qsort: procedure               /* quicksort on lists */
  use arg l
  if null(l) then return .nil
  p = car(l)
  smaller = .nil; larger = .nil
  do x over cdr(l)
    if x < p then smaller = cons(x, smaller)
    else larger = cons(x, larger)
  end
  return append(qsort(smaller), list(p), qsort(larger))

sum: procedure                 /* plain recursion */
  use arg l
  if null(l) then return 0
  return car(l) + sum(cdr(l))

flatten: procedure
  use arg x
  if null(x) then return .nil
  if atom(x) then return list(x)
  return append(flatten(car(x)), flatten(cdr(x)))

square: procedure; return arg(1) * arg(1)
even:   procedure; return arg(1) // 2 = 0
plus:   procedure; return arg(1) + arg(2)
times:  procedure; return arg(1) * arg(2)
minus:  procedure; return arg(1) - arg(2)
divide: procedure; return arg(1) / arg(2)
```

**Figure 65.** 09_lisp.rexx

```
rexx 09_lisp.rexx
(+ 1 2 3)              = 6
(* 2 (+ 3 4))         = 14
(- 10 (/ 9 3) 1)       = 6
(max 4 (* 2 5) 7)      = 10
list      (5 3 8 1 9 2)
sorted    (1 2 3 5 8 9)
sum       28
squares   (25 9 64 1 81 4)
evens     (8 2)
flattened (1 2 3 4 5 6)
bob has   1234
```

**Figure 66.** Output of 09_lisp.rexx

## Python libraries

Sales figures analysed with the Python modules statistics, collections and json: mean, median and standard deviation, a Counter, totals in a defaultdict read back as a stem, JSON text, and a Python function defined from Rexx.

```
/* 10_python.rexx - Python libraries from Rexx
 *
 * .Python~import loads a Python module; its functions and classes are
 * used with ~ like Rexx methods. Rexx numbers, strings, Arrays and
 * Directories are converted on the way in; Python numbers and strings
 * come back as Rexx strings, everything else as a PyObject.
 * The program analyses a small table of sales figures.
 */
::requires 'python'

stats = .python~import('statistics')
json = .python~import('json')
coll = .python~import('collections')

/* the data: one Rexx Directory per sale */
sales = .array~new
call sale 'Zurich', 'tea', 120
call sale 'Bern', 'coffee', 340
call sale 'Zurich', 'coffee', 210
call sale 'Basel', 'tea', 90
call sale 'Bern', 'tea', 150
call sale 'Zurich', 'cocoa', 60

amounts = .array~new
do s over sales
  amounts~append(s['amount'])
end
say 'sales     ' amounts~makestring('line', ' ')
say 'total     ' .python~sum(amounts)
say 'mean      ' stats~mean(amounts)
say 'median    ' stats~median(amounts)
say 'stdev     ' format(stats~stdev(amounts), , 2)

/* a Counter of the products, most common first */
products = .array~new
do s over sales
  products~append(s['product'])
end
do pair over coll~Counter(products)~most_common
  say 'product   ' left(pair~at(0), 8) pair~at(1)
end

/* totals per city in a Python dict, back as a Rexx stem */
totals = coll~defaultdict(.python~eval('int'))
do s over sales
  totals~put(totals~at(s['city']) + s['amount'], s['city'])
end
totals~toStem(t.)
say 'Zurich    ' t.zurich
say 'by city   ' json~dumps(.python~dict(totals), .python~kw('sort_keys', 1))

/* the sales as JSON text and back */
text = json~dumps(sales)
say 'json      ' left(text, 60)'...'
again = json~loads(text)~toRexx
say 'read back ' again~items 'sales, first in' again[1]['city']

/* a Python function, defined from Rexx */
.python~exec('def vat(x, rate=8.1):'                    || '0a'x ||,
             '    return round(x * (1 + rate / 100), 2)')
say 'with VAT  ' .python~vat(120) .python~vat(120, .python~kw('rate', 2.6))
exit
```

```
sale: procedure expose sales
  d = .directory~new
  d['city'] = arg(1); d['product'] = arg(2); d['amount'] = arg(3)
  sales~append(d)
  return
```

**Figure 67.** 10_python.rexx

```
rexx 10_python.rexx
sales      120 340 210 90 150 60
total      970
mean       161.66666666666666
median     135.0
stdev      101.47
product    tea      3
product    coffee   2
product    cocoa    1
Zurich     390
by city    {"Basel": 90, "Bern": 490, "Zurich": 390}
json       [{"city": "Zurich", "product": "tea", "amount": 120}, {"city...
read back  6 sales, first in Zurich
with VAT   129.72 123.12
```

**Figure 68.** Output of 10_python.rexx

## Blocks

A small book list processed with blocks: select, collect, inject, count, anySatisfy, detect, reject with a variable of the program, sortWith, a counter that keeps its state in a block, and a block with several clauses.

```
/* 11_blocks.rexx - blocks and the collection methods
 *
 * A block { ... } is a small routine written where it is used.
 * { :x | expression } takes the parameter x and returns the expression;
 * { use arg x; ... } is the long form. Blocks see the variables of the
 * code that created it, and keep them when that code has returned.
 * Collections answer do, select, reject, collect, detect, inject,
 * anySatisfy, allSatisfy, count and (Arrays) sortWith.
 */
books = .array~new
call book 'Dune', 'Herbert', 1965, 412
call book 'Neuromancer', 'Gibson', 1984, 271
call book 'Foundation', 'Asimov', 1951, 255
call book 'Hyperion', 'Simmons', 1989, 482
call book 'Solaris', 'Lem', 1961, 204

say 'Before 1970:'
books~select({ :b | b['year'] < 1970 })~do({ use arg b; call show b })

say 'Titles:    ' books~collect({ :b | b['title'] })~makestring('line', ', ')
say 'Pages:     ' books~inject(0, { :sum :b | sum + b['pages'] })
say 'Long ones: ' books~count({ :b | b['pages'] > 400 })
say 'Any by Lem?' books~anySatisfy({ :b | b['author'] = 'Lem' })
first = books~detect({ :b | b['year'] > 1980 })
say 'First after 1980:' first['title']

limit = 260                                  /* blocks see this variable */
short = books~reject({ :b | b['pages'] > limit })
say 'Short:     ' short~collect({ :b | b['title'] })~makestring('line', ', ')
```

```
say 'By year:'
books~sortWith({ :a :b | a['year'] <= b['year'] })~do({ use arg b; call show b })

/* a block that keeps its own state: a counter made by a routine */
next = counter(100)
say 'Tickets:   ' next~call next~call next~call

/* the long form, with several clauses */
stats = { use arg list
          total = list~inject(0, { :s :x | s + x })
          return 'n='list~items 'mean='format(total / list~items, , 1) }
say 'Stats:     ' stats~call(books~collect({ :b | b['pages'] }))
exit

book: procedure expose books
  d = .directory~new
  d['title'] = arg(1); d['author'] = arg(2); d['year'] = arg(3); d['pages'] = arg(4)
  books~append(d)
  return

show: procedure
  use arg b
  say '  ' left(b['title'], 12) left(b['author'], 8) b['year']
  return

counter: procedure
  use arg n
  return { n = n + 1; return n }
```

**Figure 69.** 11_blocks.rexx

```
rexx 11_blocks.rexx
Before 1970:
   Dune         Herbert  1965
   Foundation   Asimov   1951
   Solaris      Lem      1961
Titles:     Dune, Neuromancer, Foundation, Hyperion, Solaris
Pages:      1624
Long ones:  2
Any by Lem? 1
First after 1980: Neuromancer
Short:      Foundation, Solaris
By year:
   Foundation   Asimov   1951
   Solaris      Lem      1961
   Dune         Herbert  1965
   Neuromancer  Gibson   1984
   Hyperion     Simmons  1989
Tickets:    101 102 103
Stats:      n=5 mean=324.8
```

**Figure 70.** Output of 11_blocks.rexx

## More collections and extensions

Words counted with a Bag and a Set, the longest words in a SortedCollection with a sort block, set intersection, an Interval, new methods for String and Array with `::extension`, and cleanup with `ensure` followed by `condition('O')`.

```
/* 12_extensions.rexx - more collections, ::extension and ensure
 *
```

```
 * Interval, Set, Bag and SortedCollection, new methods for the built-in
 * classes String and Array with ::extension, a cleanup that always runs
 * with ensure, and a condition object.
 */
text = 'the quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog the end'
words = text~makearray(' ')

/* a Bag counts, a Set keeps each word once */
counts = .bag~new
do w over words; counts~add(w); end
unique = .set~new
do w over words; unique~add(w); end
say 'words:' words~items 'different:' unique~items 'the:' counts~occurrencesOf('the')

/* a SortedCollection ordered by a block: longest words first */
longest = .sortedCollection~new({ :a :b | length(a) >= length(b) })
do w over unique; longest~add(w); end
say 'longest:' longest~section(1, 3)~makestring('line', ', ')

/* set operations */
vowels = .set~of('a', 'e', 'i', 'o', 'u')
letters = .set~new
do i over 1~to(length(text)); letters~add(substr(text, i, 1)); end
say 'vowels used:' letters~intersection(vowels)~items 'of' vowels~items

/* an Interval: the squares of the odd numbers below 10 */
say 'odd squares:' 1~to(9, 2)~collect({ :n | n * n })~join(' ')

/* new methods for built-in classes, see ::extension below */
say 'title case:' 'regina rexx with objects'~titleCase
say 'average word length:' format(words~collect({ :w | length(w) })~average, , 2)

/* ensure: the cleanup runs although the work fails */
signal on syntax
{ say 'opening the file'; call work }~ensure({ say 'closing the file' })
exit
syntax:
c = condition('O')
say 'error' c['CODE'] 'in line' c['POSITION']':' c['ERRORTEXT']
exit

work: return 1 / 0

::extension String
::method titleCase
  return self~makearray(' ')~collect({ :w | translate(left(w, 1)) || substr(w, 2) })~join('
')

::extension Array
::method join
  use arg sep
  return self~inject('', { use arg s, x; if s == '' then return x; return s || sep || x })
::method average
  return self~inject(0, { :s :x | s + x }) / self~items
```

**Figure 71.** 12_extensions.rexx

```
rexx 12_extensions.rexx
words: 11 different: 9 the: 3
longest: quick, brown, jumps
vowels used: 5 of 5
odd squares: 1 9 25 49 81
```

```
title case: Regina Rexx With Objects
average word length: 3.73
opening the file
closing the file
error 42.3 in line 37: Arithmetic overflow/underflow
```

**Figure 72.** Output of 12_extensions.rexx

## cREXX and NetRexx notation

An Account class used with the notation of cREXX and NetRexx in an ordinary OO program: `.Account('Ann', 100)`, `acct.deposit(50)`, chains, a named constructor `.Account.empty()`, `this` and `null`, USE ARG defaults, and the type tests `is`, `as`, `typeof` and `<=` (Chapter 10).

```
/* 13_notation.rexx - cREXX and NetRexx notation in any OO program
 *
 * The usual Regina OO notation obj~m(args) can also be written obj.m(args),
 * as in cREXX and NetRexx. The period sends a message only when the
 * symbol before it holds an object: x.1 stays a compound variable.
 */
acct = .Account('Ann', 100)          -- .Class(args) is .Class~new(args)
acct.deposit(50)                     -- obj.m(args), also as an instruction
say acct.owner() 'has' acct.balance()
say acct.deposit(25).balance()       -- chains: a.b().c()

/* class methods and named constructors */
say .Account.count() 'account(s)'
bob = .Account.empty('Bob')
say bob.describe()

/* this (self) and null (.nil) while no variable of that name is set */
say (acct.partner() == null) 'no partner yet'
acct.link(bob)
say acct.partner().owner()

/* USE ARG defaults */
call greet
call greet 'Hello', 'Rexx'

/* type tests: is, as, typeof, and NetRexx's  x <= Class */
say (acct is .Account) (acct is .string) typeof(acct)
say (bob <= .Account) ('abc' <= .Account)
safe = acct as .Account
say safe.owner()

/* the classic meaning stays */
x.1 = 'one'; this = 'a variable'
say x.1 '/' this
exit

greet: procedure
  use arg word = 'Hi', who = 'world'
  say word who
  return

::class Account
::attribute owner get
::attribute balance get
::attribute partner get
::method init
  expose owner balance partner
```

```
  use arg owner, balance = 0
  partner = null
  this.class().added()
::method count class
  expose n
  if symbol('n') \== 'VAR' then n = 0
  return n
::method added class
  expose n
  if symbol('n') \== 'VAR' then n = 0
  n = n + 1
::method empty class
  use arg owner
  return this.new(owner)            -- this is the class in a class method
::method deposit
  expose balance
  use arg amount
  balance = balance + amount
  return this                       -- for chains
::method link
  expose partner
  use arg partner
::method describe
  return this.owner() 'with' this.balance()
```

**Figure 73.** 13_notation.rexx

```
rexx 13_notation.rexx
Ann has 150
175
1 account(s)
Bob with 0
1 no partner yet
Bob
Hi world
Hello Rexx
1 0 ACCOUNT
1 0
Ann
one / a variable
```

**Figure 74.** Output of 13_notation.rexx

## A NetRexx program

A stock list written in NetRexx (`options netrexx`): classes with properties, constructors named like the class, a subclass that calls `super()`, a static property counting the items, typed arguments, `loop ... over`, `null` and properties read and set as `bolt.count`.

```
options netrexx
/* 14_netrexx.rexx - a NetRexx program run by Regina
 *
 * "options netrexx" (or a file name ending in .nrx) switches the NetRexx
 * notation on: classes with properties and methods, constructors named
 * like the class, Name(args) to create objects, obj.prop and obj.m(args),
 * loop, typed arguments (checked when the method is called).
 */
inv = Inventory()
inv.add(Item('bolt', 120, 0.05))
inv.add(Item('nut', 300, 0.02))
inv.add(Tool('wrench', 4, 12.50, 'steel'))
```

```
say inv.size() 'kinds of items, worth' inv.value().format(, 2)
loop it over inv.items
  say ' ' it.describe()
end
low = inv.below(10)
say 'low stock:' low
bolt = inv.find('bolt')
bolt.count = bolt.count - 100                -- a property is set
say bolt.name 'now' bolt.count
say 'items created:' Item.created
say (bolt <= Item) (bolt <= Tool) (inv.find('wrench') <= Item)

class Item
  properties static
    created = 0
  properties
    name = String
    count = int
    price = 0
  method Item(aname, acount = int, aprice)
    name = aname; count = acount; price = aprice
    created = created + 1
  method value returns double
    return count * price
  method describe returns String
    return name.left(8) count.right(5) value().format(5, 2)

class Tool extends Item
  properties
    material
  method Tool(aname, acount = int, aprice, amaterial = 'iron')
    super(aname, acount, aprice)
    material = amaterial
  method describe returns String
    return super.describe() '('material')'

class Inventory
  properties
    items
  method Inventory
    items = .list~new
  method add(it)
    items.append(it)
  method size returns int
    return items.items()
  method value returns double
    total = 0
    loop it over items
      total = total + it.value()
    end
    return total
  method find(name)
    loop it over items
      if it.name = name then return it
    end
    return null
  method below(n = int) returns String
    names = ''
    loop it over items
      if it.count < n then names = names it.name
    end
    return names.strip()
```

**Figure 75.** 14_netrexx.rexx

```
rexx 14_netrexx.rexx
3 kinds of items, worth 62.00
  bolt       120     6.00
  nut        300     6.00
  wrench       4    50.00 (steel)
low stock: wrench
bolt now 20
items created: 3
1 0 1
```

**Figure 76.** Output of 14_netrexx.rexx

## A cREXX Level B program

Vehicles written in cREXX Level B (`options levelb`): an interface with a default and a named factory, two classes implementing it, a `match` that makes the truck class answer for specifications such as `truck:7.5`, procedures with typed arguments, `is`, `as` and a declaration `count = .int`.

```
options levelb
/* 15_levelb.rexx - a cREXX Level B program run by Regina
 *
 * "options levelb" switches the cREXX notation on: interfaces with
 * factories, classes implementing them, attributes (_name = .type),
 * methods "name: method = .type", procedures, typed arguments and
 * declarations. .vehicle("...") asks every class implementing the
 * interface (their "match") which one should make the object.
 */
namespace garage expose vehicle

main: procedure = .int
  arg args = .string[]
  fleet = .array~new
  fleet~append(.vehicle("mini"))
  fleet~append(.vehicle("truck:7.5"))
  fleet~append(.vehicle.electric(60))
  do v over fleet
    say v.describe() 'wheels:' v.wheels() typeof(v)
  end
  say 'load of the fleet:' load(fleet) 't'
  t = fleet[2] as .vehicle
  say (t is .truck) (t is .car)
  count = .int
  say 'count starts at' count
  return 0

load: procedure = .float
  arg list = .vehicle[]
  total = 0
  do v over list
    if v is .truck then total = total + v.tons()
  end
  return total

vehicle: interface
  *: factory
  arg spec = .string
  electric: factory
  arg kwh = .int

  describe: method = .string
```

```
    return kind() || ":" || name()
  kind: method = .string
  name: method = .string
  wheels: method = .int

car: class implements .vehicle
  _name = .string
  _battery = .int

  *: factory
    arg spec = .string
    _name = spec
    return

  electric: factory
    arg kwh = .int
    _name = "e-car"
    _battery = kwh
    return

  kind: method = .string
    if _battery > 0 then return "car(" || _battery || " kWh)"
    return "car"
  name: method = .string
    return _name
  wheels: method = .int
    return 4

truck: class implements .vehicle
  _name = .string
  _tons = .float

  *: match
    arg spec = .string
    if left(spec, 6) = "truck:" then return 10
    return 0

  *: factory
    arg spec = .string
    parse var spec _name ":" _tons
    return

  kind: method = .string
    return "truck"
  name: method = .string
    return _name
  wheels: method = .int
    return 6
  tons: method = .float
    return _tons
```

**Figure 77.** 15_levelb.rexx

```
rexx 15_levelb.rexx
car:mini wheels: 4 CAR
truck:truck wheels: 6 TRUCK
car(60 kWh):e-car wheels: 4 CAR
load of the fleet: 7.5 t
1 0
count starts at 0
```

**Figure 78.** Output of 15_levelb.rexx

## MQTT samples

The folder `demo/mqtt` holds three programs that use the RgMqtt package (Chapter 7). They need `regina` (on Windows `regina.exe`, not the standalone `rexx`) and a broker: the host and port are the arguments, for example `regina 13_mqtt.rexx localhost 1883`; 15_public_broker.rexx uses the public test broker test.mosquitto.org by default. The `packages` test suite runs them against its test broker; the outputs below are from those runs (the port of the test broker is shown as @PORT@). With test.mosquitto.org, 15_public_broker.rexx first prints the broker's version, for example `broker: mosquitto version 2.0.18`.

### MQTT with the function package

A home monitor written as a classic program with the functions of RgMqtt: one connection publishes temperatures as retained messages, a second one subscribes with a wildcard, computes statistics and publishes an alarm, and a third connection, opened later, still receives the retained values. A will announces when the monitor disappears.

```
/* 13_mqtt.rexx - MQTT with the RgMqtt function package
 *
 * A small home monitor: one connection publishes temperatures, another
 * one subscribes, computes statistics and raises an alarm. A third
 * connection, opened later, still gets the last values because they are
 * retained by the broker. Runs with any broker:
 *
 *   regina 13_mqtt.rexx [host [port]]          (default localhost 1883)
 */
parse arg host port
if host = '' then host = 'localhost'
if port = '' then port = 1883
call RxFuncAdd 'MqttLoadFuncs', 'rgmqtt', 'MqttLoadFuncs'
call MqttLoadFuncs

/* the monitor: its will tells others when it disappears */
opt.willtopic = 'home/status/monitor'; opt.willmessage = 'offline'
monitor = MqttConnect(host, port, 'home-monitor', 'opt.')
if monitor = 0 then do
  say 'no connection to' host':'port '-' MqttError()
  exit 1
end
call MqttSubscribe monitor, 'home/+/temperature', 1
call MqttSubscribe monitor, 'home/alarm', 1

/* the sensors publish retained readings with QoS 1 */
sensors = MqttConnect(host, port, 'home-sensors')
reading.1 = 'kitchen 21.5'; reading.2 = 'garden 12.0'
reading.3 = 'cellar 9.5';   reading.4 = 'office 26.5'
reading.0 = 4
do i = 1 to reading.0
  parse var reading.i room value
  call MqttPublish sensors, 'home/'room'/temperature', value, 1, 1
end

/* the monitor collects the readings and raises an alarm above 25 */
count = 0; sum = 0; low = ''; high = ''
do while MqttReceive(monitor, 'msg.', 1)
  if msg.topic = 'home/alarm' then do
    say 'ALARM received:' msg.message
    iterate
  end
  parse var msg.topic 'home/' room '/temperature'
  say left(room, 8) right(msg.message, 5) 'C'
  count = count + 1; sum = sum + msg.message
  if low = '' | msg.message < low then low = msg.message
```

```
  if high = '' | msg.message > high then high = msg.message
  if msg.message > 25 then
    call MqttPublish monitor, 'home/alarm', room 'is too warm:' msg.message 'C', 1
end
say count 'readings, average' format(sum / count, , 1) 'C, from' low 'to' high

/* a late subscriber gets the retained values */
late = MqttConnect(host, port, 'home-late')
call MqttSubscribe late, 'home/+/temperature', 1
n = 0
do while MqttReceive(late, 'msg.', 1)
  n = n + 1; got.n = msg.topic msg.message msg.retain
end
call sort
say 'a late subscriber got' n 'retained values:'
do i = 1 to n
  parse var got.i topic value retained
  say ' ' topic '=' value '(retained:' retained')'
end

/* remove the retained values again and disconnect */
do i = 1 to reading.0
  parse var reading.i room .
  call MqttPublish sensors, 'home/'room'/temperature', '', 1, 1
end
call MqttDisconnect late
call MqttDisconnect sensors
call MqttDisconnect monitor
exit 0

sort: procedure expose got. n          /* insertion sort of got.1 .. got.n */
  do i = 2 to n
    x = got.i
    do j = i - 1 to 1 by -1 while got.j >> x
      k = j + 1; got.k = got.j
    end
    k = j + 1; got.k = x
  end
  return
```

**Figure 79.** 13_mqtt.rexx

```
regina 13_mqtt.rexx 127.0.0.1 @PORT@
kitchen   21.5 C
garden    12.0 C
cellar     9.5 C
office    26.5 C
ALARM received: office is too warm: 26.5 C
4 readings, average 17.4 C, from 9.5 to 26.5
a late subscriber got 4 retained values:
  home/cellar/temperature = 9.5 (retained: 1)
  home/garden/temperature = 12.0 (retained: 1)
  home/kitchen/temperature = 21.5 (retained: 1)
  home/office/temperature = 26.5 (retained: 1)
```

**Figure 80.** Output of 13_mqtt.rexx

### MQTT with the Mqtt class

A calculator service and its client on two connections, written with `::requires 'mqtt'`. The service answers each request in a method of a Calculator class called from a `listen` block; the client collects the replies in a SortedCollection. The last part shows `listen` stopping when its block returns 0.

```
/* 14_mqtt_oo.rexx - MQTT with the Mqtt class
 *
 * A calculator service that answers requests sent over MQTT, written
 * with ::requires 'mqtt'. The client and the service use separate
 * connections; listen calls a block for every message.
 *
 *   regina 14_mqtt_oo.rexx [host [port]]       (default localhost 1883)
 */
parse arg host port
if host = '' then host = 'localhost'
if port = '' then port = 1883

service = .mqtt~connect(host, port, 'calc-service')
if service == .nil then do
  say 'no connection to' host':'port '-' .mqtt~error
  exit 1
end
client = .mqtt~connect(host, port, 'calc-client')
say 'connected to' service~host

service~subscribe('calc/request', 1)
client~subscribe('calc/reply/+', 1)

/* the client sends its requests: id, operand, operator, operand */
jobs = .array~of('1 6 * 7', '2 2 ** 10', '3 22 / 7', '4 1 / 0', '5 17 // 5')
do job over jobs
  client~publish('calc/request', job, 1)
end

/* the service answers each request */
calc = .Calculator~new(service)
say 'requests answered:' service~listen({ use arg m; calc~answer(m) }, 1)

/* the client collects the replies, sorted by request id */
replies = .sortedCollection~new
client~listen({ use arg m; replies~add(m~topic~substr(12)':' m~message) }, 1)
do r over replies
  say r
end

/* listen stops early when the block returns 0 */
do i = 1 to 3; client~publish('calc/reply/x', 'note' i); end
say 'notes read:' client~listen({ :m | m~message \== 'note 2' }, 1)
say 'last:' client~receive(1)

client~disconnect
service~disconnect
exit 0

::requires 'mqtt'

::class Calculator
::method init
  expose mqtt
  use arg mqtt

::method answer                          /* m: an MqttMessage */
  expose mqtt
  use arg m
  parse value m~message with id a op b
  select
    when \datatype(a, 'N') | \datatype(b, 'N') then r = 'not a number'
```

```
    when op = '+'  then r = a + b
    when op = '-'  then r = a - b
    when op = '*'  then r = a * b
    when op = '**' then r = a ** b
    when op = '//' then r = a // b
    when op = '/' & b = 0 then r = 'division by zero'
    when op = '/'  then r = format(a / b, , 4)
    otherwise r = 'unknown operator' op
  end
  mqtt~publish('calc/reply/'id, a op b '=' r, 1)
```

**Figure 81.** 14_mqtt_oo.rexx

```
regina 14_mqtt_oo.rexx 127.0.0.1 @PORT@
connected to 127.0.0.1
requests answered: 5
1: 6 * 7 = 42
2: 2 ** 10 = 1024
3: 22 / 7 = 3.1429
4: 1 / 0 = division by zero
5: 17 // 5 = 2
notes read: 2
last: calc/reply/x=note 3
```

**Figure 82.** Output of 14_mqtt_oo.rexx

### A public test broker

Without arguments the program connects to test.mosquitto.org, the free test server of the Eclipse Mosquitto project (port 1883 without a password; port 1884 with user `rw` and password `readwrite`). It works below a topic of its own, publishes with QoS 0, 1 and 2, reads the messages back, and removes its retained message at the end. Never publish anything private on a public broker: everybody can read it.

```
/* 15_public_broker.rexx - MQTT with a public test broker
 *
 * Uses test.mosquitto.org, the free test server of the Eclipse Mosquitto
 * project, so it runs without a broker of your own:
 *
 *   regina 15_public_broker.rexx                          port 1883, anonymous
 *   regina 15_public_broker.rexx test.mosquitto.org 1884 rw readwrite
 *   regina 15_public_broker.rexx myhost 1883             any other broker
 *
 * RgMqtt has no TLS, so use the ports without encryption (1883, 1884).
 * Everybody can read what is published on a public broker: never send
 * anything private. The program works below a topic of its own,
 * regina-oo/<client id>, and removes its retained message at the end.
 */
parse arg host port user password
if host = '' then host = 'test.mosquitto.org'
if port = '' then port = 1883

/* a client id nobody else uses */
id = 'regina-oo-' || date('B') || right(time('S'), 5, '0') || random(1000, 9999)
root = 'regina-oo/'id

opts = .directory~new
opts~keepAlive = 30
opts~timeout = 20                      /* public servers can be slow */
opts~willTopic = root'/status'; opts~willMessage = 'gone'
if user \= '' then do; opts~user = user; opts~password = password; end
say 'connecting to' host 'port' port
c = .mqtt~connect(host, port, id, opts)
```

```
if c == .nil then do
  say 'no connection:' .mqtt~error
  exit 1
end

/* the broker's version, if it publishes it in $SYS */
if c~subscribe('$SYS/broker/version') >= 0 then do
  m = c~receive(3)
  if m \== .nil then say 'broker:' m~message
  c~unsubscribe('$SYS/broker/version')
end

/* publish to our own topics and read the messages back */
say 'subscribe:' c~subscribe(root'/#', 2)
c~publish(root'/status', 'online', 1, 1)            /* retained */
do qos = 0 to 2
  c~publish(root'/greeting/qos'qos, 'Hello from Regina Rexx OO, QoS' qos, qos)
end
got = .sortedCollection~new
n = c~listen({ use arg m; got~add(m~topic~substr(length(root) + 2) '=' m~message) }, 5)
say n 'messages came back:'
do line over got; say ' ' line; end
say 'ping:' c~ping

/* remove the retained message and leave */
c~publish(root'/status', '', 1, 1)
say 'disconnect:' c~disconnect
exit 0
::requires 'mqtt'
```

**Figure 83.** 15_public_broker.rexx

```
regina 15_public_broker.rexx 127.0.0.1 @PORT@
connecting to 127.0.0.1 port @PORT@
subscribe: 2
4 messages came back:
  greeting/qos0 = Hello from Regina Rexx OO, QoS 0
  greeting/qos1 = Hello from Regina Rexx OO, QoS 1
  greeting/qos2 = Hello from Regina Rexx OO, QoS 2
  status = online
ping: 1
disconnect: 1
```

**Figure 84.** Output of 15_public_broker.rexx

# Chapter 9. Restrictions and Known Problems

## Memory

- **Garbage collection.** Objects that no variable, collection or object refers to any more are freed. The collection runs between clauses when the number of objects has doubled since the last one (at least 10,000 objects), so programs with few objects never pay for it. An object that a clause may still use (in `a + f()`, F may drop the last variable that refers to A) is kept until that clause has ended. `--no-gc` or `REGINA_GC=off` switch the collection off; then objects live until the program ends.
- A handle kept only outside of variables and objects, for example in the external queue or in a file, does not keep its object alive. After the object has been collected the handle is an ordinary string.
- While an external Rexx program called by the program runs, no collection takes place.
- All objects of a program are freed when the program ends, also when it is called through the REXX API.

## Language

- The ooRexx features listed in Chapter 5 under "Not available" are missing, notably RAISE, FORWARD, GUARD, REPLY, START and many classes.
- An array can have up to 64 dimensions and at most 100,000,000 places in all (error 88.6).
- A function given by name to `map`, `filter`, `reduce`, `mapcar` or `apply` must be an internal routine, a `::routine`, a built-in function or a method; external routines are not searched. LISP lists use the CAR/CDR recursion of LISP, so very long lists are better handled with `DO x OVER` than with deep recursion.
- `sort` orders the string values of the items; use `sortWith` with a block for other orders.
- The new keywords need a marker, a directive, an earlier message operator or `--oo` (Chapter 3). A program that uses objects only through routine arguments, without any of these, must add a marker to use them.
- Directives are not allowed in INTERPRET data (error 98.2).
- Only a plain stem argument (`st.`) is passed by reference; a compound variable or an expression is passed by value. `RETURN x.` returns a copy, and `EXIT x.` returns the stem's string value as in classic REXX.
- An operator with an object as right operand and a string as left operand uses the object's string value; the object's operator method is not called.
- Class IDs of classes defined with `::class` are in uppercase.
- PUBLIC and PRIVATE on `::class` and `::routine` are accepted but have no effect: all classes and routines of a file loaded with `::requires` are visible to the program that loads it.
- The collection of a DO OVER loop is copied when the loop starts; changes in the body do not affect the loop.
- In a block only the names of a first `USE ARG` are parameters; `ARG` and `PARSE ARG` in a block set variables of the creator if it has them.
- A block keeps the variables of its creator as a copy made when the creator returns; two routines cannot share variables through a block after both have returned.
- Objects belong to the thread that created them and cannot be shared between threads that run REXX programs at the same time.
- NetRexx and cREXX Level B programs are translated to Regina OO before they run; Chapter 10 lists what of these languages is not available.

## Python

- The built-in Python is a subset of Python 3 (see the manual of github.com/mikebeer/python): strings are byte strings, there is no `async`, and the libraries are pure-Python versions of the standard library, NumPy, pandas and SciPy. C extension modules of CPython cannot be loaded.
- Python calls Rexx code only as blocks; a routine is passed as a block that calls it, `{ :x | myroutine(x) }`.

- A string that looks like a number is passed as a number; use `.python~str(s)` for a string such as a postal code `007`.
- An operator with a PyObject on the right and a Rexx string on the left (`2 * a`) uses the string value of the object; write `a * 2`.
- Python objects referred to by Rexx live until the program ends, like all objects.
- There is one Python interpreter per process; it is not shared safely between threads.

## Errors and tracing

- An error in a file loaded by `::requires` names the main program in the error message, not the required file.
- TRACE I shows the hidden position counter of DO OVER loops.
- Deep recursion of methods ends with error 11 (control stack full) when three quarters of the C stack are used. The stack is that of the executable (on Linux `ulimit -s`, at most 64 MB counted; `rexx.exe`, `regina.exe` and the macOS build 256 MB) unless `--stack=SIZE` or `REGINA_STACK` asks for another size: the interpreter then runs on a thread with a stack of that size, for example `rexx --stack=512M prog.rexx` (Appendix B). Deep recursion of classic internal routines is not checked, as in Regina 3.9.7.

## Platforms

| Package | Status |
|---|---|
| Linux x86-64 (`.deb`) | Built and tested natively: all five test suites, valgrind. Contains `regina`, which loads external function packages such as RgMqtt. |
| Windows 64-bit (zip) | Cross-compiled with MinGW-w64. Under Wine, the oo and samples suites pass with `rexx.exe` and `regina.exe`, and the MQTT tests and samples with `regina.exe` and `rgmqtt.dll`. On Windows 11 itself: programs typed in and ended with Ctrl-Z, `animal.rexx`, `--stack=512M` with deeply nested methods, and the MQTT sample with the public broker test.mosquitto.org. No readline, curses or GCI. Both executables have a 256 MB stack; `--stack=SIZE` or `REGINA_STACK` sets another size. `tools/test-windows.sh` also checks programs with a console (input typed in, Ctrl-Z, programs that end). |
| macOS (tar.gz) | Cross-compiled with zig for Apple Silicon and Intel, macOS 11 or later. The same sources and configuration pass all test suites on Linux, but the binary has not yet been run on a Mac. It is ad-hoc signed, not notarized (see Chapter 2). No readline, curses or GCI, and no external function packages. |

**Figure 85.** Platform status

## Performance

Classic programs run at the speed of Regina 3.9.7: built with the same compiler options, the REXXCPS benchmark gave a median of 9.67 million clauses per second against 9.51 million for Regina 3.9.7 (seven runs each), a difference within the noise of the measurement. A message is slower than a call of an internal routine, because it creates a new variable scope and looks up the method. Collections are implemented in C and are fast; a loop over thousands of items is no problem.

# Chapter 10. cREXX and NetRexx Notation

cREXX and NetRexx are two other object-oriented members of the REXX family. Both write a message with a period, `obj.m(args)`, where ooRexx and Regina Rexx OO write `obj~m(args)`, and both declare classes differently. Regina Rexx OO accepts their notation at three levels:

| Level | Switched on by | What it gives |
|---|---|---|
| The common notation | every OO program (a directive, a marker, a message or `--oo`) | `obj.m(args)`, `.Class(args)`, `.Class.f(args)`, `this`, `null`, `USE ARG name = default`, `x is .T`, `x as .T`, `typeof(x)`, `x <= .T` |
| NetRexx programs | `options netrexx` as the first instruction, or a file name ending in `.nrx` | classes, properties, methods and constructors in NetRexx syntax, `Name(args)`, `obj.prop`, `loop`, typed arguments |
| cREXX Level B programs | `options levelb` as the first instruction | interfaces, classes, attributes, factories with `match`, methods, procedures, typed arguments and declarations |

**Figure 86.** The three levels of the dialect notations

None of this changes a classic program: the new meanings apply only in OO programs, and `--no-oo` switches all of them off. The period sends a message only when the symbol before it holds an object, so a compound variable such as `x.1` or `rec.name` keeps its classic meaning.

## The common notation

| Written | Means | Note |
|---|---|---|
| `obj.m(args)` | `obj~m(args)` | when the variable OBJ holds an object; otherwise the classic call of the function `OBJ.M` |
| `a.b(1).c()` | `a~b(1)~c()` | a period directly after `)` or `]` and followed by a name and `(` is a message |
| `obj.m(args)` as an instruction | the message instruction `obj~m(args)` | not a command to the environment; RESULT is set |
| `.Class(args)` | `.Class~new(args)` | when `.Class` is a class object |
| `.Class.f(args)` | `.Class~f(args)` | a class method, for example a named constructor |
| `this` | `self` | only while no variable THIS is set; `this.m()` sends m to self |
| `null` | `.nil` | only while no variable NULL is set |
| `use arg a, b = 5` | B is 5 when the second argument is omitted | the default is any expression; it is evaluated only when needed |
| `x is .T` | `x~isA(.T)`: 1 or 0 | the right operand must start with a period and a letter |
| `x as .T` | x, when `x~isA(.T)` | otherwise error 88.9 |
| `typeof(x)` | the ID of the class of x | only when no label or ::routine TYPEOF exists |
| `x <= .T`, `.T >= x` | `x~isA(.T)` | the NetRexx type test; only when the operand is a class object |

**Figure 87.** The common notation

`is` and `as` compare like the comparison operators, so they bind less tightly than concatenation: write `say (x is .Array) (y is .String)`. In a program where IS or AS is a variable, `is .T` and `as .T` are still the operators; `x is` without a following period keeps the classic meaning.

```
acct = .Account('Ann', 100)
acct.deposit(50)
say acct.owner() 'has' acct.balance()
say (acct is .Account) typeof(acct)
```

```
::class Account
::attribute owner get
::attribute balance get
::method init
  expose owner balance
  use arg owner, balance = 0
::method deposit
  expose balance
  use arg amount
  balance = balance + amount
  return this
```

**Figure 88.** The common notation in an OO program

## NetRexx programs

A program that starts with `options netrexx`, or whose file name ends in `.nrx`, is a NetRexx program. Before it is parsed it is translated into Regina OO: every line of the translation is the same line of the program, so line numbers in error messages and in TRACE output are those of the program. TRACE shows the translated clauses. The translation is done in memory; the file is not changed.

| NetRexx | Regina OO | Note |
|---|---|---|
| `class Point extends Shape implements Named` | `::class Point subclass Shape inherit Named public` | an interface of the same file becomes a mixin class; other interfaces (Java) are ignored |
| `class Named interface` | `::class Named mixinclass Object` | its methods are abstract |
| `properties [static] [indirect]` and `x = int`, `y = 5`, `s` | instance (or class) variables with attributes `x`, `y`, `s` | typed properties start as 0 (int, float, boolean) or `.nil`; `indirect` adds `getX` and `setX` |
| `method Point(a, b = 0)` | `::method init` with `use arg a, b = 0` | the constructor; it calls the superclass constructor first |
| `super(args)`, `this(args)` | the superclass constructor, another constructor | |
| `method area(n = int) static returns double` | `::method area class` with `use arg n` and a check | RETURNS and SIGNALS are accepted and ignored |
| `Point(1, 2)`, `Point.origin()`, `Point.count` | `.Point(1, 2)`, `.Point~origin()`, `.Point~count` | for the classes of the program; other classes are found at run time |
| `describe()` in a method | `self~describe()` | the methods of the class are called without `this.` |
| `p.x`, `p.x = 5` | `p~x`, `p~x = 5` | at run time, when P holds an object |
| `s.length()`, `s.upper` | `s~length()`, `s~upper` | strings take messages, too |
| `loop i = 1 to 10`, `loop for 3`, `loop x over list` | `do i = 1 to 10`, `do 3`, `do x over list` | |
| `n = int`, `a = int[5]` | `drop n`, `a = .array~new(5)` | a declaration; an array |
| `ask`, `parse ask x` | `linein()`, `parse pull x` | |
| a line ending in `-` | a line ending in `,` | the NetRexx continuation |
| `import`, `package` | (removed) | |

**Figure 89.** The translation of NetRexx

Statements before the first class are the main program. Without them, the static method `main` of the first class that has one is run, with the argument string of the program. A NetRexx file can also be loaded with `::requires 'geometry.nrx'`; its classes are then available, and its `main` method is not run.

**Typed arguments** are checked when the method is called: `int`, `long`, `short` and `byte` need a whole number, `float` and `double` a number, `boolean` 0 or 1, and `char` one character. Otherwise error 88.10 is raised, for example "by must be of type int; found "x"". Other types (Rexx, String, classes) are not checked.

**Not available:** the Java class library and everything that needs it (`java.lang`, `Vector`, `ArrayList`, Swing), `catch` and `finally`, `signal` of exceptions, casts written as `int s`, overloading (two methods of the same name with different arguments), `select case`, compile-time type checking and `binary` arithmetic. The methods of a subclass reach the properties of its superclass through their attributes (`self~x`), which the translation writes for them.

## cREXX Level B programs

A program that starts with `options levelb` is a cREXX Level B program. It is translated in the same way as a NetRexx program, line for line.

| Level B | Regina OO | Note |
|---|---|---|
| `vehicle: interface` | `::class vehicle mixinclass Object` | methods without a body are abstract; a method with a body is a default method |
| `car: class implements .vehicle .named` | `::class car inherit vehicle named` | |
| `_name = .string` (in the class) | an instance variable, exposed in all methods | starts as '' (string), 0 (int, float, boolean), an empty Array (`.t[]`) or `.nil`; `with register.N` is ignored |
| `*: factory` with `arg spec = .string` | the constructor `init` with `use arg spec` | without an `arg` line the class factory takes the arguments of the interface factory |
| `from_size: factory` | the class method `from_size` | creates the object without the default factory and runs the body |
| `*: match`, `from_size: match` | class methods that score a provider | the highest positive score wins, ties go to the first name in alphabetical order, a class without match scores 1 |
| `.vehicle("mini")`, `.vehicle.from_size(8)` | the factory of the selected class | all classes of the program that implement the interface are asked |
| `describe: method = .string` | `::method describe` | the result type is ignored |
| `add: procedure = .int` with `arg a = .int` | `::routine add` with `use arg a` and a check | `main: procedure` is run when there are no statements before it |
| `call clear()`, `size()` in a method | `self~clear()`, `self~size()` | |
| `count = .int` | `count = 0` | a declaration |
| `list[0]` | `list~items()` | the number of items |
| `<typeof>(x)`, `.ns..vehicle` | `typeof(x)`, `.vehicle` | namespaces are not needed |
| `import mylib`, `namespace n` | `::requires 'mylib'` at the end, (removed) | imports of the cREXX libraries (`rx...`) are dropped |

**Figure 90.** The translation of cREXX Level B

Typed arguments (`.int`, `.float`, `.decimal`, `.boolean`) are checked as in NetRexx programs, with error 88.10. `x is .car` is true for a subclass of car as well; in cREXX it is true only for the class itself. `typeof` returns the class ID in uppercase (`CAR`) and `String` for a string.

**Not available:** the cREXX libraries (`rxfnsb` and the others; Regina's built-in functions are used instead), Level G and the other levels, `reference` arguments that change the caller's variable, `procedure expose`, module globals, `OBJECT_NOT_INITIALIZED`, assembler and `with register` layouts, and compile-time type checking.

The sample programs 13_notation.rexx, 14_netrexx.rexx and 15_levelb.rexx (Chapter 8) show the three levels.

# Appendix A. Error Messages

The messages of the extension, as printed by the English message file. "..." stands for a name or value filled in at run time. The texts are also available in German; the other languages show the English texts.

| Error | Message |
|---|---|
| 88.0 | Invalid argument |
| 88.1 | Method "...": argument n must be a positive whole number; found "..." |
| 88.2 | Method "...": argument n must be a class object; found "..." |
| 88.3 | Method "...": argument n is required |
| 88.4 | Method "...": argument n must be an Array; found "..." |
| 88.5 | Method "...": argument n must be a non-negative whole number; found "..." |
| 88.6 | Array index ... exceeds the maximum of 100000000 |
| 88.7 | Method "...": argument n must be a whole number; found "..." |
| 88.8 | Method "...": argument n must not be zero |
| 88.9 | Value "..." is not an instance of ... |
| 88.10 | ... must be of type ...; found "..." |
| 91.0 | No result object |
| 91.1 | Message "..." did not return a result |
| 97.0 | Object method not found |
| 97.1 | Object "..." does not understand message "..." |
| 98.0 | Execution error |
| 98.1 | Class "..." not found |
| 98.2 | Directives are not allowed in INTERPRET data |
| 98.3 | Could not find the required file "..." |
| 98.4 | ... is only valid in a method |
| 98.5 | DO OVER: "..." is not a collection |
| 98.6 | Method "..." is abstract |
| 98.7 | Mixin class "..." cannot create instances |
| 98.8 | Method "..." needs a one-dimensional array |
| 98.9 | Supplier has no more items |
| 98.10 | Class "..." would inherit from itself |
| 98.11 | The array has ... dimension(s), but ... index(es) were given |
| 98.12 | The list is circular |
| 98.13 | Invalid list: ... |
| 98.14 | Python: ... |
| 98.15 | Python is not available in this build |
| 98.16 | The block is used after the routine that created it has ended; begin the block with PROCEDURE |
| 98.17 | Method "..." would change the order of a SortedCollection; use ADD |
| 98.18 | ...: cannot open the file "..." |
| 98.19 | The workspace has no name; use [ |
| 99.0 | Translation error |
| 99.1 | Unknown directive "::..." |

| Error | Message |
|---|---|
| 99.2 | Duplicate ::CLASS "..." |
| 99.3 | Duplicate method "..." in class "..." |
| 99.4 | ::... must follow a ::CLASS directive |
| 99.5 | Missing name in ::... directive |
| 99.6 | Invalid option "..." in ::... directive |
| 99.7 | Duplicate ::ROUTINE "..." |
| 99.8 | Block not closed: "}" expected |
| 99.9 | Invalid block parameters: ":name ..." must be followed by a vertical bar and an expression |
| 99.10 | Class "..." not found |

**Figure 91.** Error messages of the extension

Errors of the extension are SYNTAX conditions: `SIGNAL ON SYNTAX` traps them, RC holds the main number and `condition('D')` the message.

# Appendix B. Switches and Environment Variables

| Switch or variable | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `--oo`, `-O` | The OO keywords are on in every program, required file and INTERPRET string. |
| `--no-oo`, `-N` | The extension is off: Regina 3.9.7 behaviour. |
| `REGINA_OO` | `on`, `1`, `yes` or `oo` act like `--oo`; `off`, `0`, `no` or `classic` like `--no-oo`. A command-line switch wins. |
| `--gc`, `-G` / `--no-gc`, `-g` | Garbage collection of objects on (the default) or off. `--gc=stress` collects before every clause, for testing. |
| `REGINA_GC` | `on`, `off` (also `0`, `no`) or `stress`, like the switches; a command-line switch wins. |
| `--stack=SIZE`, `-ZSIZE` | Runs the interpreter on a thread with a C stack of SIZE bytes; K, M and G may follow the number (`--stack=512M`). At least 1M; at most 2047M on Windows, 64G elsewhere. Deeply nested methods then end with error 11 later. Must come before the program name. |
| `REGINA_STACK` | The same SIZE as the switch, for programs started without it (for example `#!` scripts); the switch wins. |
| `--ws[=wsid]`, `-W` | An interactive workspace session; with WSID the workspace WSID.rxws is loaded first. |
| `REGINA_MACROS` | Folders searched for external routines and for `::requires` files. |
| `REGINA_LANG`, `REGINA_LANG_DIR` | Language of the error messages and the folder of the `*.mtb` files. |
| `PYLIB` | Folders searched for Python modules, separated by `:` (`;` on Windows), before the library of the installation. |

**Figure 92.** Switches and environment variables

All other switches of Regina 3.9.7 work as before; `rexx -h` lists them.

# Appendix C. Contents of the Packages

| Package | Contents |
|---|---|
| Debian | `/usr/bin`: rexx, regina, rxstack, rxqueue, regina-config<br>`/usr/lib/<arch>`: libregina.so, libregina.a, the packages RegUtil and RgMqtt (librgmqtt.so)<br>`/usr/share/regina-rexx`: message files, the classic examples and `pylib` (the Python library)<br>`/usr/share/doc/regina-rexx-oo`: README.OO.md, this manual, examples (the OO samples)<br>`/usr/share/man/man1`: man pages |
| Windows | `rexx.exe`, `regina.exe`, `regina.dll`, `rgmqtt.dll`, `README.rgmqtt.txt`, `*.mtb`, `pylib` (the Python library), `README.txt`, `README.OO.md`, this manual, `COPYING-LIB.txt`, `demo` with the classic examples, `demo\oo` with the OO samples and `demo\mqtt` with the MQTT samples |
| macOS | `rexx` (universal), `*.mtb`, `pylib`, `INSTALL-macOS.txt`, `README.OO.md`, this manual, `COPYING-LIB.txt`, `demo` and `demo/oo` |

**Figure 93.** Package contents